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Aggregating certificate authority certificates for authenticating network entities located in different trust zones

Abstract

Operations of a certificate authority (CA) service may include aggregating in a certificate repository, a plurality of sets of CA certificates, in which each set of CA certificates is issued by a particular CA that is associated with a particular trust zone and that is trusted by a particular set of network entities located in the particular trust zone. The operations may further include distributing for access by an additional set of network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the plurality of sets of CA certificates. The additional set of network entities may utilize the plurality of sets of CA certificates to authenticate network entities located in different trust zones.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to certificate authority (CA) certificates utilized to authenticate entity certificates presented by network entities. More particularly, the present disclosure relates to authentication of network entities located in different trust zones.

BACKGROUND

(2) A computing network, such as a virtual cloud network, includes network entities that communicate with one another. Communications between network entities may be performed in accordance with a security protocol whereby network entities authenticate one another by presenting a digital certificate. When a network entity presents a valid digital certificate to another network entity, the other network entity can trust that it is communicating with the network entity, as opposed to some unknown entity, based on a trust relationship with the CA that issued the digital certificate. A digital certificate may be issued to a network entity by a CA. The digital certificate may include a digital signature generated using a private key of the CA that issued the digital certificate. The digital signature can be validated using a CA certificate of the CA that includes a public key corresponding to the private key.

(3) The content of this background section should not be construed as prior art merely by virtue of its presence in this section.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The embodiments are illustrated by way of example and not by way of limitation in the figures of the accompanying drawings. It should be noted that references to “an” or “one” embodiment in this disclosure are not necessarily to the same embodiment, and they mean at least one. In the drawings:

(2) FIGS. 1-4 are block diagrams illustrating patterns for implementing a cloud infrastructure as a service system in accordance with one or more embodiments;

(3) FIG. 5 is a hardware system in accordance with one or more embodiments;

(4) FIGS. 6A-6D illustrate features of an example system in accordance with one or more embodiments; and

(5) FIG. 7 is a flowchart that illustrates example operations pertaining to aggregating CA certificates in accordance with one or more embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) In the following description, for the purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding. One or more embodiments may be practiced without these specific details. Features described in one embodiment may be combined with features described in a different embodiment. In some examples, well-known structures and devices are described with reference to a block diagram form in order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring the present invention. 1. GENERAL OVERVIEW 2. CLOUD COMPUTING TECHNOLOGY 3. COMPUTER SYSTEM 4. ARCHITECTURAL OVERVIEW 5.

AGGREGATING CERTIFICATE AUTHORITY CERTIFICATES 6. AUTHENTICATING

NETWORK ENTITIES 7. MISCELLANEOUS; EXTENSIONS

1. General Overview

(7) One or more embodiments aggregate and distribute certificate authority (CA) certificates, associated with a plurality of CAs in different trust zones, for enabling a system to authenticate entity certificates issued by different respective CAs in different trust zones. A system may receive a first set of CA certificates from a first CA service located in a first trust zone associated with a first CA that is trusted by a first set of network entities, and a second set of CA certificates from a second CA service located in a second trust zone associated with a second CA that is trusted by a second set of network entities. The system may aggregate the first set of CA certificates and the second set of CA certificates and may distributing for access by a third set of network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the first set of CA certificates and the second set of CA certificates. The third set of network entities may use the first set of CA certificates to establish trust with the first CA and to authenticate a first set of entity certificates issued by the first CA to the first set of network entities. Additionally, the third set of network entities may use the second set of CA certificates to establish trust with the second CA and to authenticate a second set of entity certificates issued by the second CA to the second set of network entities.

(8) In one example, the system may aggregate CA certificates for use by an interzone CA service. The interzone CA service may use the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate network entities in connection with initially provisioning and/or updating interzone network entities that may communicate across trust zone boundaries, such as with other network entities located outside of a particular trust zone. A particular trust zone may encompass all or a portion of a virtual cloud network. Additionally, or in the alternative, a particular trust zone may encompass a plurality of virtual cloud networks. In one example, the system may aggregate CA certificates from different CAs associated with trust zones for use with respect to network entities that engage in communications across trust zone boundaries. The network entities may use the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate network entities located in different trust zones, as well as network entities located within the same trust zone. By distributing an aggregate set of CA certificates, the respective network entities have access to all of the CA certificates that are needed for initially

provisioning and/or updating interzone network entities, as well as the CA certificates that are needed to establish trust with CAs associated with different trust zones and to authenticate network entities located in different trust zones.

(9) One or more embodiments described in this Specification and/or recited in the claims may not be included in this General Overview section.

2. Cloud Computing Technology

(10) Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) is an application of cloud computing technology. IaaS can be configured to provide virtualized computing resources over a public network (e.g., the Internet). In an IaaS model, a cloud computing provider can host the infrastructure components (e.g., servers, storage devices, network nodes (e.g., hardware), deployment software, platform virtualization (e.g., a hypervisor layer), or the like). In some cases, an IaaS provider may also supply a variety of services to accompany those infrastructure components (example services include billing software, monitoring software, logging software, load balancing software, clustering software, etc.). Thus, as these services may be policy-driven, IaaS users may be able to implement policies to drive load balancing to maintain application availability and performance.

(11) In some instances, IaaS customers may access resources and services through a wide area network (WAN), such as the Internet, and can use the cloud provider's services to install the remaining elements of an application stack. For example, the user can log in to the IaaS platform to create virtual machines (VMs), install operating systems (OSs) on each VM, deploy middleware such as databases, create storage buckets for workloads and backups, and even install enterprise software into that VM. Customers can then use the provider's services to perform various functions, including balancing network traffic, troubleshooting application issues, monitoring performance, managing disaster recovery, etc.

(12) In some cases, a cloud computing model will involve the participation of a cloud provider. The cloud provider may, but need not be, a third-party service that specializes in providing (e.g., offering, renting, selling) IaaS. An entity may also opt to deploy a private cloud, becoming its own provider of infrastructure services.

(13) In some examples, IaaS deployment is the process of implementing a new application, or a new version of an application, onto a prepared application server or other similar device. IaaS deployment may also include the process of preparing the server (e.g., installing libraries, daemons, etc.). The deployment process is often managed by the cloud provider, below the hypervisor layer (e.g., the servers, storage, network hardware, and virtualization). Thus, the customer may be responsible for handling (OS), middleware, and/or application deployment (e.g., on self-service virtual machines (e.g., that can be spun up on demand) or the like).

(14) In some examples, IaaS provisioning may refer to acquiring computers or virtual hosts for use, and even installing needed libraries or services on them. In most cases, deployment does not include provisioning, and the provisioning may need to be performed first.

(15) In some cases, there are challenges for IaaS provisioning. There is an initial challenge of provisioning the initial set of infrastructure. There is an additional challenge of evolving the existing infrastructure (e.g., adding new services, changing services, removing services, etc.) after the initial provisioning is completed. In some cases, these challenges may be addressed by enabling the configuration of the infrastructure to be defined declaratively. In other words, the infrastructure (e.g., what components are needed and how they interact) can be defined by one or more configuration files. Thus, the overall topology of the infrastructure (e.g., what resources depend on which, and how they each work together) can be described declaratively. In some instances, once the topology is defined, a workflow can be generated that creates and/or manages the different components described in the configuration files.

(16) In some examples, an infrastructure may have many interconnected elements. For example, there may be one or more virtual private clouds (VPCs) (e.g., a potentially on-demand pool of configurable and/or shared computing resources), also known as a core network. In some examples,

there may also be one or more inbound/outbound traffic group rules provisioned to define how the inbound and/or outbound traffic of the network will be set up and one or more virtual machines (VMs). Other infrastructure elements may also be provisioned, such as a load balancer, a database, or the like. As more and more infrastructure elements are desired and/or added, the infrastructure may incrementally evolve.

(17) In some instances, continuous deployment techniques may be employed to enable deployment of infrastructure code across various virtual computing environments. Additionally, the described techniques can enable infrastructure management within these environments. In some examples, service teams can write code that is desired to be deployed to one or more, but often many, different production environments (e.g., across various different geographic locations, sometimes spanning the entire world). In some embodiments, infrastructure and resources may be provisioned (manually, and/or using a provisioning tool) prior to deployment of code to be executed on the infrastructure. However, in some examples, the infrastructure on which the code will be deployed must first be set up. In some instances, the provisioning can be done manually, a provisioning tool may be utilized to provision the resources, and/or deployment tools may be utilized to deploy the code once the infrastructure is provisioned.

(18) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example pattern of an IaaS architecture **100**, according to at least one embodiment. Service operators **102** can be communicatively coupled to a secure host tenancy **104** that can include a virtual cloud network (VCN) **106** and a secure host subnet **108**. In some examples, the service operators **102** may be using one or more client computing devices, which may be portable handheld devices (e.g., an iPhone®, cellular telephone, an iPad®, computing tablet, a personal digital assistant (PDA)) or wearable devices (e.g., a Google Glass® head mounted display), running software such as Microsoft Windows Mobile®, and/or a variety of mobile operating systems such as iOS, Windows Phone, Android, BlackBerry 8, Palm OS, and the like, and being Internet, e-mail, short message service (SMS), Blackberry®, or other communication protocol enabled. Alternatively, the client computing devices can be general purpose personal computers including, by way of example, personal computers and/or laptop computers running various versions of Microsoft Windows®, Apple Macintosh®, and/or Linux operating systems. The client computing devices can be workstation computers running any of a variety of commercially-available UNIX® or UNIX-like operating systems, including without limitation the variety of GNU/Linux operating systems, such as for example, Google Chrome OS. Alternatively, or in addition, client computing devices may be any other electronic device, such as a thin-client computer, an Internet-enabled gaming system (e.g., a Microsoft Xbox gaming console with or without a Kinect® gesture input device), and/or a personal messaging device, capable of communicating over a network that can access the VCN **106** and/or the Internet.

(19) The VCN **106** can include a local peering gateway (LPG) **110** that can be communicatively coupled to a secure shell (SSH) VCN **112** via an LPG **110** contained in the SSH VCN **112**. The SSH VCN **112** can include an SSH subnet **114**, and the SSH VCN **112** can be communicatively coupled to a control plane VCN **116** via the LPG **110** contained in the control plane VCN **116**. Also, the SSH VCN **112** can be communicatively coupled to a data plane VCN **118** via an LPG **110**. The control plane VCN **116** and the data plane VCN **118** can be contained in a service tenancy **119** that can be owned and/or operated by the IaaS provider.

(20) The control plane VCN **116** can include a control plane demilitarized zone (DMZ) tier **120** that acts as a perimeter network (e.g., portions of a corporate network between the corporate intranet and external networks). The DMZ-based servers may have restricted responsibilities and help keep breaches contained. Additionally, the DMZ tier **120** can include one or more load balancer (LB) subnet(s) **122**, a control plane app tier **124** that can include app subnet(s) **126**, a control plane data tier **128** that can include database (DB) subnet(s) **130** (e.g., frontend DB subnet(s) and/or backend DB subnet(s)). The LB subnet(s) **122** contained in the control plane DMZ tier **120** can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **126** contained in the control plane app tier **124** and

an Internet gateway **134** that can be contained in the control plane VCN **116**, and the app subnet(s) **126** can be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **130** contained in the control plane data tier **128** and a service gateway **136** and a network address translation (NAT) gateway **138**. The control plane VCN **116** can include the service gateway **136** and the NAT gateway **138**.

(21) The control plane VCN **116** can include a data plane mirror app tier **140** that can include app subnet(s) **126**. The app subnet(s) **126** contained in the data plane mirror app tier **140** can include a virtual network interface controller (VNIC) **142** that can execute a compute instance **144**. The compute instance **144** can communicatively couple the app subnet(s) **126** of the data plane mirror app tier **140** to app subnet(s) **126** that can be contained in a data plane app tier **146**.

(22) The data plane VCN **118** can include the data plane app tier **146**, a data plane DMZ tier **148**, and a data plane data tier **150**. The data plane DMZ tier **148** can include LB subnet(s) **122** that can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **126** of the data plane app tier **146** and the Internet gateway **134** of the data plane VCN **118**. The app subnet(s) **126** can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **136** of the data plane VCN **118** and the NAT gateway **138** of the data plane VCN **118**. The data plane data tier **150** can also include the DB subnet(s) **130** that can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **126** of the data plane app tier **146**.

(23) The Internet gateway **134** of the control plane VCN **116** and of the data plane VCN **118** can be communicatively coupled to a metadata management service **152** that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet **154**. Public Internet **154** can be communicatively coupled to the NAT gateway **138** of the control plane VCN **116** and of the data plane VCN **118**. The service gateway **136** of the control plane VCN **116** and of the data plane VCN **118** can be communicatively couple to cloud services **156**.

(24) In some examples, the service gateway **136** of the control plane VCN **116** or of the data plane VCN **118** can make application programming interface (API) calls to cloud services **156** without going through public Internet **154**. The API calls to cloud services **156** from the service gateway **136** can be one-way: the service gateway **136** can make API calls to cloud services **156**, and cloud services **156** can send requested data to the service gateway **136**. But, cloud services **156** may not initiate API calls to the service gateway **136**.

(25) In some examples, the secure host tenancy **104** can be directly connected to the service tenancy **119**, which may be otherwise isolated. The secure host subnet **108** can communicate with the SSH subnet **114** through an LPG **110** that may enable two-way communication over an otherwise isolated system. Connecting the secure host subnet **108** to the SSH subnet **114** may give the secure host subnet **108** access to other entities within the service tenancy **119**.

(26) The control plane VCN **116** may allow users of the service tenancy **119** to set up or otherwise provision desired resources. Desired resources provisioned in the control plane VCN **116** may be deployed or otherwise used in the data plane VCN **118**. In some examples, the control plane VCN **116** can be isolated from the data plane VCN **118**, and the data plane mirror app tier **140** of the control plane VCN **116** can communicate with the data plane app tier **146** of the data plane VCN **118** via VNICs **142** that can be contained in the data plane mirror app tier **140** and the data plane app tier **146**.

(27) In some examples, users of the system, or customers, can make requests, for example create, read, update, or delete (CRUD) operations, through public Internet **154** that can communicate the requests to the metadata management service **152**. The metadata management service **152** can communicate the request to the control plane VCN **116** through the Internet gateway **134**. The request can be received by the LB subnet(s) **122** contained in the control plane DMZ tier **120**. The LB subnet(s) **122** may determine that the request is valid, and in response to this determination, the LB subnet(s) **122** can transmit the request to app subnet(s) **126** contained in the control plane app tier **124**. If the request is validated and requires a call to public Internet **154**, the call to public Internet **154** may be transmitted to the NAT gateway **138** that can make the call to public Internet **154**. Metadata that may be desired to be stored by the request can be stored in the DB subnet(s)

130.

(28) In some examples, the data plane mirror app tier **140** can facilitate direct communication between the control plane VCN **116** and the data plane VCN **118**. For example, changes, updates, or other suitable modifications to configuration may be desired to be applied to the resources contained in the data plane VCN **118**. Via a VNIC **142**, the control plane VCN **116** can directly communicate with, and can thereby execute the changes, updates, or other suitable modifications to configuration to, resources contained in the data plane VCN **118**.

(29) In some embodiments, the control plane VCN **116** and the data plane VCN **118** can be contained in the service tenancy **119**. In this case, the user, or the customer, of the system may not own or operate either the control plane VCN **116** or the data plane VCN **118**. Instead, the IaaS provider may own or operate the control plane VCN **116** and the data plane VCN **118**, both of which may be contained in the service tenancy **119**. This embodiment can enable isolation of networks that may prevent users or customers from interacting with other users', or other customers', resources. Also, this embodiment may allow users or customers of the system to store databases privately without needing to rely on public Internet **154**, which may not have a desired level of threat prevention, for storage.

(30) In other embodiments, the LB subnet(s) **122** contained in the control plane VCN **116** can be configured to receive a signal from the service gateway **136**. In this embodiment, the control plane VCN **116** and the data plane VCN **118** may be configured to be called by a customer of the IaaS provider without calling public Internet **154**. Customers of the IaaS provider may desire this embodiment since database(s) that the customers use may be controlled by the IaaS provider and may be stored on the service tenancy **119**, which may be isolated from public Internet **154**.

(31) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating another example pattern of an IaaS architecture **200**, according to at least one embodiment. Service operators **202** (e.g., service operators **102** of FIG. 1) can be communicatively coupled to a secure host tenancy **204** (e.g., the secure host tenancy **104** of FIG. 1) that can include a virtual cloud network (VCN) **206** (e.g., the VCN **106** of FIG. 1) and a secure host subnet **208** (e.g., the secure host subnet **108** of FIG. 1). The VCN **206** can include a local peering gateway (LPG) **210** (e.g., the LPG **110** of FIG. 1) that can be communicatively coupled to a secure shell (SSH) VCN **212** (e.g., the SSH VCN **112** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **110** contained in the SSH VCN **212**. The SSH VCN **212** can include an SSH subnet **214** (e.g., the SSH subnet **114** of FIG. 1), and the SSH VCN **212** can be communicatively coupled to a control plane VCN **216** (e.g., the control plane VCN **116** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **210** contained in the control plane VCN **216**. The control plane VCN **216** can be contained in a service tenancy **219** (e.g., the service tenancy **119** of FIG. 1), and the data plane VCN **218** (e.g., the data plane VCN **118** of FIG. 1) can be contained in a customer tenancy **221** that may be owned or operated by users, or customers, of the system.

(32) The control plane VCN **216** can include a control plane DMZ tier **220** (e.g., the control plane DMZ tier **120** of FIG. 1) that can include LB subnet(s) **222** (e.g., LB subnet(s) **122** of FIG. 1), a control plane app tier **224** (e.g., the control plane app tier **124** of FIG. 1) that can include app subnet(s) **226** (e.g., app subnet(s) **126** of FIG. 1), a control plane data tier **228** (e.g., the control plane data tier **128** of FIG. 1) that can include database (DB) subnet(s) **230** (e.g., similar to DB subnet(s) **130** of FIG. 1). The LB subnet(s) **222** contained in the control plane DMZ tier **220** can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **226** contained in the control plane app tier **224** and an Internet gateway **234** (e.g., the Internet gateway **134** of FIG. 1) that can be contained in the control plane VCN **216**, and the app subnet(s) **226** can be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **230** contained in the control plane data tier **228** and a service gateway **236** (e.g., the service gateway **136** of FIG. 1) and a network address translation (NAT) gateway **238** (e.g., the NAT gateway **138** of FIG. 1). The control plane VCN **216** can include the service gateway **236** and the NAT gateway **238**.

(33) The control plane VCN **216** can include a data plane mirror app tier **240** (e.g., the data plane

mirror app tier **140** of FIG. 1) that can include app subnet(s) **226**. The app subnet(s) **226** contained in the data plane mirror app tier **240** can include a virtual network interface controller (VNIC) **242** (e.g., the VNIC of **142**) that can execute a compute instance **244** (e.g., similar to the compute instance **144** of FIG. 1). The compute instance **244** can facilitate communication between the app subnet(s) **226** of the data plane mirror app tier **240** and the app subnet(s) **226** that can be contained in a data plane app tier **246** (e.g., the data plane app tier **146** of FIG. 1) via the VNIC **242** contained in the data plane mirror app tier **240** and the VNIC **242** contained in the data plane app tier **246**.

(34) The Internet gateway **234** contained in the control plane VCN **216** can be communicatively coupled to a metadata management service **252** (e.g., the metadata management service **152** of FIG. 1) that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet **254** (e.g., public Internet **154** of FIG. 1). Public Internet **254** can be communicatively coupled to the NAT gateway **238** contained in the control plane VCN **216**. The service gateway **236** contained in the control plane VCN **216** can be communicatively couple to cloud services **256** (e.g., cloud services **156** of FIG. 1).

(35) In some examples, the data plane VCN **218** can be contained in the customer tenancy **221**. In this case, the IaaS provider may provide the control plane VCN **216** for each customer, and the IaaS provider may, for each customer, set up a unique, compute instance **244** that is contained in the service tenancy **219**. Each compute instance **244** may allow communication between the control plane VCN **216**, contained in the service tenancy **219**, and the data plane VCN **218** that is contained in the customer tenancy **221**. The compute instance **244** may allow resources, that are provisioned in the control plane VCN **216** that is contained in the service tenancy **219**, to be deployed or otherwise used in the data plane VCN **218** that is contained in the customer tenancy **221**.

(36) In other examples, the customer of the IaaS provider may have databases that live in the customer tenancy **221**. In this example, the control plane VCN **216** can include the data plane mirror app tier **240** that can include app subnet(s) **226**. The data plane mirror app tier **240** can reside in the data plane VCN **218**, but the data plane mirror app tier **240** may not live in the data plane VCN **218**. That is, the data plane mirror app tier **240** may have access to the customer tenancy **221**, but the data plane mirror app tier **240** may not exist in the data plane VCN **218** or be owned or operated by the customer of the IaaS provider. The data plane mirror app tier **240** may be configured to make calls to the data plane VCN **218** but may not be configured to make calls to any entity contained in the control plane VCN **216**. The customer may desire to deploy or otherwise use resources in the data plane VCN **218** that are provisioned in the control plane VCN **216**, and the data plane mirror app tier **240** can facilitate the desired deployment, or other usage of resources, of the customer.

(37) In some embodiments, the customer of the IaaS provider can apply filters to the data plane VCN **218**. In this embodiment, the customer can determine what the data plane VCN **218** can access, and the customer may restrict access to public Internet **254** from the data plane VCN **218**. The IaaS provider may not be able to apply filters or otherwise control access of the data plane VCN **218** to any outside networks or databases. Applying filters and controls by the customer onto the data plane VCN **218**, contained in the customer tenancy **221**, can help isolate the data plane VCN **218** from other customers and from public Internet **254**.

(38) In some embodiments, cloud services **256** can be called by the service gateway **236** to access services that may not exist on public Internet **254**, on the control plane VCN **216**, or on the data plane VCN **218**. The connection between cloud services **256** and the control plane VCN **216** or the data plane VCN **218** may not be live or continuous. Cloud services **256** may exist on a different network owned or operated by the IaaS provider. Cloud services **256** may be configured to receive calls from the service gateway **236** and may be configured to not receive calls from public Internet **254**. Some cloud services **256** may be isolated from other cloud services **256**, and the control plane VCN **216** may be isolated from cloud services **256** that may not be in the same region as the control plane VCN **216**. For example, the control plane VCN **216** may be located in “Region 1,”

and cloud service “Deployment 1,” may be located in Region 1 and in “Region 2.” If a call to Deployment 1 is made by the service gateway **236** contained in the control plane VCN **216** located in Region 1, the call may be transmitted to Deployment 1 in Region 1. In this example, the control plane VCN **216**, or Deployment 1 in Region 1, may not be communicatively coupled to, or otherwise in communication with, Deployment 1 in Region 2.

(39) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating another example pattern of an IaaS architecture **300**, according to at least one embodiment. Service operators **302** (e.g., service operators **102** of FIG. 1) can be communicatively coupled to a secure host tenancy **304** (e.g., the secure host tenancy **104** of FIG. 1) that can include a virtual cloud network (VCN) **306** (e.g., the VCN **106** of FIG. 1) and a secure host subnet **308** (e.g., the secure host subnet **108** of FIG. 1). The VCN **306** can include an LPG **310** (e.g., the LPG **110** of FIG. 1) that can be communicatively coupled to an SSH VCN **312** (e.g., the SSH VCN **112** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **310** contained in the SSH VCN **312**. The SSH VCN **312** can include an SSH subnet **314** (e.g., the SSH subnet **114** of FIG. 1), and the SSH VCN **312** can be communicatively coupled to a control plane VCN **316** (e.g., the control plane VCN **116** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **310** contained in the control plane VCN **316** and to a data plane VCN **318** (e.g., the data plane VCN **118** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **310** contained in the data plane VCN **318**. The control plane VCN **316** and the data plane VCN **318** can be contained in a service tenancy **319** (e.g., the service tenancy **119** of FIG. 1).

(40) The control plane VCN **316** can include a control plane DMZ tier **320** (e.g., the control plane DMZ tier **120** of FIG. 1) that can include load balancer (LB) subnet(s) **322** (e.g., LB subnet(s) **122** of FIG. 1), a control plane app tier **324** (e.g., the control plane app tier **124** of FIG. 1) that can include app subnet(s) **326** (e.g., similar to app subnet(s) **126** of FIG. 1), a control plane data tier **328** (e.g., the control plane data tier **128** of FIG. 1) that can include DB subnet(s) **330**. The LB subnet(s) **322** contained in the control plane DMZ tier **320** can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **326** contained in the control plane app tier **324** and to an Internet gateway **334** (e.g., the Internet gateway **134** of FIG. 1) that can be contained in the control plane VCN **316**, and the app subnet(s) **326** can be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **330** contained in the control plane data tier **328** and to a service gateway **336** (e.g., the service gateway of FIG. 1) and a network address translation (NAT) gateway **338** (e.g., the NAT gateway **138** of FIG. 1). The control plane VCN **316** can include the service gateway **336** and the NAT gateway **338**.

(41) The data plane VCN **318** can include a data plane app tier **346** (e.g., the data plane app tier **146** of FIG. 1), a data plane DMZ tier **348** (e.g., the data plane DMZ tier **148** of FIG. 1), and a data plane data tier **350** (e.g., the data plane data tier **150** of FIG. 1). The data plane DMZ tier **348** can include LB subnet(s) **322** that can be communicatively coupled to trusted app subnet(s) **360** and untrusted app subnet(s) **362** of the data plane app tier **346** and the Internet gateway **334** contained in the data plane VCN **318**. The trusted app subnet(s) **360** can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **336** contained in the data plane VCN **318**, the NAT gateway **338** contained in the data plane VCN **318**, and DB subnet(s) **330** contained in the data plane data tier **350**. The untrusted app subnet(s) **362** can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **336** contained in the data plane VCN **318** and DB subnet(s) **330** contained in the data plane data tier **350**. The data plane data tier **350** can include DB subnet(s) **330** that can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **336** contained in the data plane VCN **318**.

(42) The untrusted app subnet(s) **362** can include one or more primary VNICS **364(1)-(N)** that can be communicatively coupled to tenant virtual machines (VMs) **366(1)-(N)**. Each tenant VM **366(1)-(N)** can be communicatively coupled to a respective app subnet **367(1)-(N)** that can be contained in respective container egress VCNs **368(1)-(N)** that can be contained in respective customer tenancies **380(1)-(N)**. Respective secondary VNICS **372(1)-(N)** can facilitate communication between the untrusted app subnet(s) **362** contained in the data plane VCN **318** and the app subnet contained in the container egress VCNs **368(1)-(N)**. Each container egress VCNs **368(1)-(N)** can include a NAT gateway **338** that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet

354 (e.g., public Internet **154** of FIG. **1**).

(43) The Internet gateway **334** contained in the control plane VCN **316** and contained in the data plane VCN **318** can be communicatively coupled to a metadata management service **352** (e.g., the metadata management service **152** of FIG. **1**) that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet **354**. Public Internet **354** can be communicatively coupled to the NAT gateway **338** contained in the control plane VCN **316** and contained in the data plane VCN **318**. The service gateway **336** contained in the control plane VCN **316** and contained in the data plane VCN **318** can be communicatively couple to cloud services **356**.

(44) In some embodiments, the data plane VCN **318** can be integrated with customer tenancies **380**. This integration can be useful or desirable for customers of the IaaS provider in some cases such as a case that may desire support when executing code. The customer may provide code to run that may be destructive, may communicate with other customer resources, or may otherwise cause undesirable effects. In response to this, the IaaS provider may determine whether to run code given to the IaaS provider by the customer.

(45) In some examples, the customer of the IaaS provider may grant temporary network access to the IaaS provider and request a function to be attached to the data plane app tier **346**. Code to run the function may be executed in the VMs **366(1)-(N)**, and the code may not be configured to run anywhere else on the data plane VCN **318**. Each VM **366(1)-(N)** may be connected to one customer tenancy **380**. Respective containers **381(1)-(N)** contained in the VMs **366(1)-(N)** may be configured to run the code. In this case, there can be a dual isolation (e.g., the containers **381(1)-(N)** running code, where the containers **381(1)-(N)** may be contained in at least the VM **366(1)-(N)** that are contained in the untrusted app subnet(s) **362**), which may help prevent incorrect or otherwise undesirable code from damaging the network of the IaaS provider or from damaging a network of a different customer. The containers **381(1)-(N)** may be communicatively coupled to the customer tenancy **380** and may be configured to transmit or receive data from the customer tenancy **380**. The containers **381(1)-(N)** may not be configured to transmit or receive data from any other entity in the data plane VCN **318**. Upon completion of running the code, the IaaS provider may kill or otherwise dispose of the containers **381(1)-(N)**.

(46) In some embodiments, the trusted app subnet(s) **360** may run code that may be owned or operated by the IaaS provider. In this embodiment, the trusted app subnet(s) **360** may be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **330** and be configured to execute CRUD operations in the DB subnet(s) **330**. The untrusted app subnet(s) **362** may be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **330**, but in this embodiment, the untrusted app subnet(s) may be configured to execute read operations in the DB subnet(s) **330**. The containers **381(1)-(N)** that can be contained in the VM **366(1)-(N)** of each customer and that may run code from the customer may not be communicatively coupled with the DB subnet(s) **330**.

(47) In other embodiments, the control plane VCN **316** and the data plane VCN **318** may not be directly communicatively coupled. In this embodiment, there may be no direct communication between the control plane VCN **316** and the data plane VCN **318**. However, communication can occur indirectly through at least one method. An LPG **310** may be established by the IaaS provider that can facilitate communication between the control plane VCN **316** and the data plane VCN **318**. In another example, the control plane VCN **316** or the data plane VCN **318** can make a call to cloud services **356** via the service gateway **336**. For example, a call to cloud services **356** from the control plane VCN **316** can include a request for a service that can communicate with the data plane VCN **318**.

(48) FIG. **4** is a block diagram illustrating another example pattern of an IaaS architecture **400**, according to at least one embodiment. Service operators **402** (e.g., service operators **102** of FIG. **1**) can be communicatively coupled to a secure host tenancy **404** (e.g., the secure host tenancy **104** of FIG. **1**) that can include a virtual cloud network (VCN) **406** (e.g., the VCN **106** of FIG. **1**) and a secure host subnet **408** (e.g., the secure host subnet **108** of FIG. **1**). The VCN **406** can include an

LPG **410** (e.g., the LPG **110** of FIG. 1) that can be communicatively coupled to an SSH VCN **412** (e.g., the SSH VCN **112** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **410** contained in the SSH VCN **412**. The SSH VCN **412** can include an SSH subnet **414** (e.g., the SSH subnet **114** of FIG. 1), and the SSH VCN **412** can be communicatively coupled to a control plane VCN **416** (e.g., the control plane VCN **116** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **410** contained in the control plane VCN **416** and to a data plane VCN **418** (e.g., the data plane VCN **118** of FIG. 1) via an LPG **410** contained in the data plane VCN **418**. The control plane VCN **416** and the data plane VCN **418** can be contained in a service tenancy **419** (e.g., the service tenancy **119** of FIG. 1).

(49) The control plane VCN **416** can include a control plane DMZ tier **420** (e.g., the control plane DMZ tier **120** of FIG. 1) that can include LB subnet(s) **422** (e.g., LB subnet(s) **122** of FIG. 1), a control plane app tier **424** (e.g., the control plane app tier **124** of FIG. 1) that can include app subnet(s) **426** (e.g., app subnet(s) **126** of FIG. 1), a control plane data tier **428** (e.g., the control plane data tier **128** of FIG. 1) that can include DB subnet(s) **430** (e.g., DB subnet(s) **330** of FIG. 3). The LB subnet(s) **422** contained in the control plane DMZ tier **420** can be communicatively coupled to the app subnet(s) **426** contained in the control plane app tier **424** and to an Internet gateway **434** (e.g., the Internet gateway **134** of FIG. 1) that can be contained in the control plane VCN **416**, and the app subnet(s) **426** can be communicatively coupled to the DB subnet(s) **430** contained in the control plane data tier **428** and to a service gateway **436** (e.g., the service gateway of FIG. 1) and a network address translation (NAT) gateway **438** (e.g., the NAT gateway **138** of FIG. 1). The control plane VCN **416** can include the service gateway **436** and the NAT gateway **438**.

(50) The data plane VCN **418** can include a data plane app tier **446** (e.g., the data plane app tier **146** of FIG. 1), a data plane DMZ tier **448** (e.g., the data plane DMZ tier **148** of FIG. 1), and a data plane data tier **450** (e.g., the data plane data tier **150** of FIG. 1). The data plane DMZ tier **448** can include LB subnet(s) **422** that can be communicatively coupled to trusted app subnet(s) **460** (e.g., trusted app subnet(s) **360** of FIG. 3) and untrusted app subnet(s) **462** (e.g., untrusted app subnet(s) **362** of FIG. 3) of the data plane app tier **446** and the Internet gateway **434** contained in the data plane VCN **418**. The trusted app subnet(s) **460** can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **436** contained in the data plane VCN **418**, the NAT gateway **438** contained in the data plane VCN **418**, and DB subnet(s) **430** contained in the data plane data tier **450**. The untrusted app subnet(s) **462** can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **436** contained in the data plane VCN **418** and DB subnet(s) **430** contained in the data plane data tier **450**. The data plane data tier **450** can include DB subnet(s) **430** that can be communicatively coupled to the service gateway **436** contained in the data plane VCN **418**.

(51) The untrusted app subnet(s) **462** can include primary VNICS **464(1)-(N)** that can be communicatively coupled to tenant virtual machines (VMs) **466(1)-(N)** residing within the untrusted app subnet(s) **462**. Each tenant VM **466(1)-(N)** can run code in a respective container **467(1)-(N)**, and be communicatively coupled to an app subnet **426** that can be contained in a data plane app tier **446** that can be contained in a container egress VCN **468**. Respective secondary VNICS **472(1)-(N)** can facilitate communication between the untrusted app subnet(s) **462** contained in the data plane VCN **418** and the app subnet contained in the container egress VCN **468**. The container egress VCN can include a NAT gateway **438** that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet **454** (e.g., public Internet **154** of FIG. 1).

(52) The Internet gateway **434** contained in the control plane VCN **416** and contained in the data plane VCN **418** can be communicatively coupled to a metadata management service **452** (e.g., the metadata management service **152** of FIG. 1) that can be communicatively coupled to public Internet **454**. Public Internet **454** can be communicatively coupled to the NAT gateway **438** contained in the control plane VCN **416** and contained in the data plane VCN **418**. The service gateway **436** contained in the control plane VCN **416** and contained in the data plane VCN **418** can be communicatively couple to cloud services **456**.

(53) In some examples, the pattern illustrated by the architecture of block diagram **400** of FIG. **4** may be considered an exception to the pattern illustrated by the architecture of block diagram **300** of FIG. **3** and may be desirable for a customer of the IaaS provider if the IaaS provider cannot directly communicate with the customer (e.g., a disconnected region). The respective containers **467(1)-(N)** that are contained in the VMs **466(1)-(N)** for each customer can be accessed in real-time by the customer. The containers **467(1)-(N)** may be configured to make calls to respective secondary VNICs **472(1)-(N)** contained in app subnet(s) **426** of the data plane app tier **446** that can be contained in the container egress VCN **468**. The secondary VNICs **472(1)-(N)** can transmit the calls to the NAT gateway **438** that may transmit the calls to public Internet **454**. In this example, the containers **467(1)-(N)** that can be accessed in real-time by the customer can be isolated from the control plane VCN **416** and can be isolated from other entities contained in the data plane VCN **418**. The containers **467(1)-(N)** may also be isolated from resources from other customers.

(54) In other examples, the customer can use the containers **467(1)-(N)** to call cloud services **456**. In this example, the customer may run code in the containers **467(1)-(N)** that requests a service from cloud services **456**. The containers **467(1)-(N)** can transmit this request to the secondary VNICs **472(1)-(N)** that can transmit the request to the NAT gateway that can transmit the request to public Internet **454**. Public Internet **454** can transmit the request to LB subnet(s) **422** contained in the control plane VCN **416** via the Internet gateway **434**. In response to determining the request is valid, the LB subnet(s) can transmit the request to app subnet(s) **426** that can transmit the request to cloud services **456** via the service gateway **436**.

(55) It should be appreciated that IaaS architectures **100**, **200**, **300**, **400** depicted in the figures may have other components than those depicted. Further, the embodiments shown in the figures are only some examples of a cloud infrastructure system that may incorporate an embodiment of the disclosure. In some other embodiments, the IaaS systems may have more or fewer components than shown in the figures, may combine two or more components, or may have a different configuration or arrangement of components.

(56) In certain embodiments, the IaaS systems described herein may include a suite of applications, middleware, and database service offerings that are delivered to a customer in a self-service, subscription-based, elastically scalable, reliable, highly available, and secure manner. An example of such an IaaS system is the Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) provided by the present assigned.

(57) In one or more embodiments, a computer network provides connectivity among a set of nodes. The nodes may be local to and/or remote from each other. The nodes are connected by a set of links. Examples of links include a coaxial cable, an unshielded twisted cable, a copper cable, an optical fiber, and a virtual link.

(58) A subset of nodes implements the computer network. Examples of such nodes include a switch, a router, a firewall, and a network address translator (NAT). Another subset of nodes uses the computer network. Such nodes (also referred to as “hosts”) may execute a client process and/or a server process. A client process makes a request for a computing service (such as, execution of a particular application, and/or storage of a particular amount of data). A server process responds by executing the requested service and/or returning corresponding data.

(59) A computer network may be a physical network, including physical nodes connected by physical links. A physical node is any digital device. A physical node may be a function-specific hardware device, such as a hardware switch, a hardware router, a hardware firewall, and a hardware NAT. Additionally or alternatively, a physical node may be a generic machine that is configured to execute various virtual machines and/or applications performing respective functions. A physical link is a physical medium connecting two or more physical nodes. Examples of links include a coaxial cable, an unshielded twisted cable, a copper cable, and an optical fiber.

(60) A computer network may be an overlay network. An overlay network is a logical network implemented on top of another network (such as, a physical network). Each node in an overlay network corresponds to a respective node in the underlying network. Hence, each node in an

overlay network is associated with both an overlay address (to address to the overlay node) and an underlay address (to address the underlay node that implements the overlay node). An overlay node may be a digital device and/or a software process (such as, a virtual machine, an application instance, or a thread) A link that connects overlay nodes is implemented as a tunnel through the underlying network. The overlay nodes at either end of the tunnel treat the underlying multi-hop path between them as a single logical link. Tunneling is performed through encapsulation and decapsulation.

(61) In an embodiment, a client may be local to and/or remote from a computer network. The client may access the computer network over other computer networks, such as a private network or the Internet. The client may communicate requests to the computer network using a communications protocol, such as Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP). The requests are communicated through an interface, such as a client interface (such as a web browser), a program interface, or an application programming interface (API).

(62) In an embodiment, a computer network provides connectivity between clients and network resources. Network resources include hardware and/or software configured to execute server processes. Examples of network resources include a processor, a data storage, a virtual machine, a container, and/or a software application. Network resources are shared amongst multiple clients. Clients request computing services from a computer network independently of each other. Network resources are dynamically assigned to the requests and/or clients on an on-demand basis. Network resources assigned to each request and/or client may be scaled up or down based on, for example, (a) the computing services requested by a particular client, (b) the aggregated computing services requested by a particular tenant, and/or (c) the aggregated computing services requested of the computer network. Such a computer network may be referred to as a “cloud network.”

(63) In an embodiment, a service provider provides a cloud network to one or more end users. Various service models may be implemented by the cloud network, including but not limited to Software-as-a-Service (SaaS), Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS), and Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS). In SaaS, a service provider provides end users the capability to use the service provider's applications, which are executing on the network resources. In PaaS, the service provider provides end users the capability to deploy custom applications onto the network resources. The custom applications may be created using programming languages, libraries, services, and tools supported by the service provider. In IaaS, the service provider provides end users the capability to provision processing, storage, networks, and other fundamental computing resources provided by the network resources. Any arbitrary applications, including an operating system, may be deployed on the network resources.

(64) In an embodiment, various deployment models may be implemented by a computer network, including but not limited to a private cloud, a public cloud, and a hybrid cloud. In a private cloud, network resources are provisioned for exclusive use by a particular group of one or more entities (the term “entity” as used herein refers to a corporation, organization, person, or other entity). The network resources may be local to and/or remote from the premises of the particular group of entities. In a public cloud, cloud resources are provisioned for multiple entities that are independent from each other (also referred to as “tenants” or “customers”). The computer network and the network resources thereof are accessed by clients corresponding to different tenants. Such a computer network may be referred to as a “multi-tenant computer network.” Several tenants may use a same particular network resource at different times and/or at the same time. The network resources may be local to and/or remote from the premises of the tenants. In a hybrid cloud, a computer network comprises a private cloud and a public cloud. An interface between the private cloud and the public cloud allows for data and application portability. Data stored at the private cloud and data stored at the public cloud may be exchanged through the interface. Applications implemented at the private cloud and applications implemented at the public cloud may have dependencies on each other. A call from an application at the private cloud to an application at the

public cloud (and vice versa) may be executed through the interface.

(65) In an embodiment, tenants of a multi-tenant computer network are independent of each other. For example, a business or operation of one tenant may be separate from a business or operation of another tenant. Different tenants may demand different network requirements for the computer network. Examples of network requirements include processing speed, amount of data storage, security requirements, performance requirements, throughput requirements, latency requirements, resiliency requirements, Quality of Service (QOS) requirements, tenant isolation, and/or consistency. The same computer network may need to implement different network requirements demanded by different tenants.

(66) In one or more embodiments, in a multi-tenant computer network, tenant isolation is implemented to ensure that the applications and/or data of different tenants are not shared with each other. Various tenant isolation approaches may be used.

(67) In an embodiment, each tenant is associated with a tenant ID. Each network resource of the multi-tenant computer network is tagged with a tenant ID. A tenant is permitted access to a particular network resource only if the tenant and the particular network resources are associated with a same tenant ID.

(68) In an embodiment, each tenant is associated with a tenant ID. Each application, implemented by the computer network, is tagged with a tenant ID. Additionally or alternatively, each data structure and/or dataset, stored by the computer network, is tagged with a tenant ID. A tenant is permitted access to a particular application, data structure, and/or dataset only if the tenant and the particular application, data structure, and/or dataset are associated with a same tenant ID.

(69) As an example, each database implemented by a multi-tenant computer network may be tagged with a tenant ID. Only a tenant associated with the corresponding tenant ID may access data of a particular database. As another example, each entry in a database implemented by a multi-tenant computer network may be tagged with a tenant ID. Only a tenant associated with the corresponding tenant ID may access data of a particular entry. However, the database may be shared by multiple tenants.

(70) In an embodiment, a subscription list indicates which tenants have authorization to access which applications. For each application, a list of tenant IDs of tenants authorized to access the application is stored. A tenant is permitted access to a particular application only if the tenant ID of the tenant is included in the subscription list corresponding to the particular application.

(71) In an embodiment, network resources (such as digital devices, virtual machines, application instances, and threads) corresponding to different tenants are isolated to tenant-specific overlay networks maintained by the multi-tenant computer network. As an example, packets from any source device in a tenant overlay network may only be transmitted to other devices within the same tenant overlay network. Encapsulation tunnels are used to prohibit any transmissions from a source device on a tenant overlay network to devices in other tenant overlay networks. Specifically, the packets, received from the source device, are encapsulated within an outer packet. The outer packet is transmitted from a first encapsulation tunnel endpoint (in communication with the source device in the tenant overlay network) to a second encapsulation tunnel endpoint (in communication with the destination device in the tenant overlay network). The second encapsulation tunnel endpoint decapsulates the outer packet to obtain the original packet transmitted by the source device. The original packet is transmitted from the second encapsulation tunnel endpoint to the destination device in the same particular overlay network.

3. Computer System

(72) FIG. 5 illustrates an example computer system **500**, in which various embodiments may be implemented. The system **500** may be used to implement any of the computer systems described above. As shown in FIG. 5, computer system **500** includes a processing unit **504** that communicates with a number of peripheral subsystems via a bus subsystem **502**. These peripheral subsystems may include a processing acceleration unit **506**, an I/O subsystem **508**, a storage subsystem **518** and a

communications subsystem **524**. Storage subsystem **518** includes tangible computer-readable storage media **522** and a system memory **510**.

(73) Bus subsystem **502** provides a mechanism for letting the various components and subsystems of computer system **500** communicate with each other as intended. Although bus subsystem **502** is shown schematically as a single bus, alternative embodiments of the bus subsystem may utilize multiple buses. Bus subsystem **502** may be any of several types of bus structures including a memory bus or memory controller, a peripheral bus, and a local bus using any of a variety of bus architectures. For example, such architectures may include an Industry Standard Architecture (ISA) bus, Micro Channel Architecture (MCA) bus, Enhanced ISA (EISA) bus, Video Electronics Standards Association (VESA) local bus, and Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus, which can be implemented as a Mezzanine bus manufactured to the IEEE P1386.1 standard.

(74) Processing unit **504**, which can be implemented as one or more integrated circuits (e.g., a conventional microprocessor or microcontroller), controls the operation of computer system **500**. One or more processors may be included in processing unit **504**. These processors may include single core or multicore processors. In certain embodiments, processing unit **504** may be implemented as one or more independent processing units **532** and/or **534** with single or multicore processors included in each processing unit. In other embodiments, processing unit **504** may also be implemented as a quad-core processing unit formed by integrating two dual-core processors into a single chip.

(75) In various embodiments, processing unit **504** can execute a variety of programs in response to program code and can maintain multiple concurrently executing programs or processes. At any given time, some or all of the program code to be executed can be resident in processing unit **504** and/or in storage subsystem **518**. Through suitable programming, processing unit **504** can provide various functionalities described above. Computer system **500** may additionally include a processing acceleration unit **506**, which can include a digital signal processor (DSP), a special-purpose processor, and/or the like.

(76) I/O subsystem **508** may include user interface input devices and user interface output devices. User interface input devices may include a keyboard, pointing devices such as a mouse or trackball, a touchpad or touch screen incorporated into a display, a scroll wheel, a click wheel, a dial, a button, a switch, a keypad, audio input devices with voice command recognition systems, microphones, and other types of input devices. User interface input devices may include, for example, motion sensing and/or gesture recognition devices such as the Microsoft Kinect® motion sensor that enables users to control and interact with an input device, such as the Microsoft Xbox® 360 game controller, through a natural user interface using gestures and spoken commands. User interface input devices may also include eye gesture recognition devices such as the Google Glass® blink detector that detects eye activity (e.g., ‘blinking’ while taking pictures and/or making a menu selection) from users and transforms the eye gestures as input into an input device (e.g., Google Glass®). Additionally, user interface input devices may include voice recognition sensing devices that enable users to interact with voice recognition systems (e.g., Siri® navigator), through voice commands.

(77) User interface input devices may also include, without limitation, three dimensional (3D) mice, joysticks or pointing sticks, gamepads and graphic tablets, and audio/visual devices such as speakers, digital cameras, digital camcorders, portable media players, webcams, image scanners, fingerprint scanners, barcode reader 3D scanners, 3D printers, laser rangefinders, and eye gaze tracking devices. Additionally, user interface input devices may include, for example, medical imaging input devices such as computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, position emission tomography, medical ultrasonography devices. User interface input devices may also include, for example, audio input devices such as MIDI keyboards, digital musical instruments and the like.

(78) User interface output devices may include a display subsystem, indicator lights, or non-visual

displays such as audio output devices, etc. The display subsystem may be a cathode ray tube (CRT), a flat-panel device, such as that using a liquid crystal display (LCD) or plasma display, a projection device, a touch screen, and the like. In general, use of the term “output device” is intended to include all possible types of devices and mechanisms for outputting information from computer system **500** to a user or other computer. For example, user interface output devices may include, without limitation, a variety of display devices that visually convey text, graphics and audio/video information such as monitors, printers, speakers, headphones, automotive navigation systems, plotters, voice output devices, and modems.

(79) Computer system **500** may comprise a storage subsystem **518** that provides a tangible non-transitory computer-readable storage medium for storing software and data constructs that provide the functionality of the embodiments described in this disclosure. The software can include programs, code modules, instructions, scripts, etc., that when executed by one or more cores or processors of processing unit **504** provide the functionality described above. Storage subsystem **518** may also provide a repository for storing data used in accordance with the present disclosure.

(80) As depicted in the example in FIG. 5, storage subsystem **518** can include various components including a system memory **510**, computer-readable storage media **522**, and a computer readable storage media reader **520**. System memory **510** may store program instructions, such as application programs **512**, that are loadable and executable by processing unit **504**. System memory **510** may also store data, such as program data **514**, that is used during the execution of the instructions and/or data that is generated during the execution of the program instructions. Various different kinds of programs may be loaded into system memory **510** including but not limited to client applications, Web browsers, mid-tier applications, relational database management systems (RDBMS), virtual machines, containers, etc.

(81) System memory **510** may also store an operating system **516**. Examples of operating system **516** may include various versions of Microsoft Windows®, Apple Macintosh®, and/or Linux operating systems, a variety of commercially-available UNIX® or UNIX-like operating systems (including without limitation the variety of GNU/Linux operating systems, the Google Chrome® OS, and the like) and/or mobile operating systems such as iOS, Windows® Phone, Android® OS, BlackBerry® OS, and Palm® OS operating systems. In certain implementations where computer system **500** executes one or more virtual machines, the virtual machines along with their guest operating systems (GOSs) may be loaded into system memory **510** and executed by one or more processors or cores of processing unit **504**.

(82) System memory **510** can come in different configurations depending upon the type of computer system **500**. For example, system memory **510** may be volatile memory (such as random access memory (RAM)) and/or non-volatile memory (such as read-only memory (ROM), flash memory, etc.) Different types of RAM configurations may be provided including a static random access memory (SRAM), a dynamic random access memory (DRAM), and others. In some implementations, system memory **510** may include a basic input/output system (BIOS) containing basic routines that help to transfer information between elements within computer system **500**, such as during start-up.

(83) Computer-readable storage media **522** may represent remote, local, fixed, and/or removable storage devices plus storage media for temporarily and/or more permanently containing, storing, computer-readable information for use by computer system **500** including instructions executable by processing unit **504** of computer system **500**.

(84) Computer-readable storage media **522** can include any appropriate media known or used in the art, including storage media and communication media, such as but not limited to, volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage and/or transmission of information. This can include tangible computer-readable storage media such as RAM, ROM, electronically erasable programmable ROM (EEPROM), flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disk (DVD), or other optical

storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or other tangible computer readable media.

(85) By way of example, computer-readable storage media **522** may include a hard disk drive that reads from or writes to non-removable, nonvolatile magnetic media, a magnetic disk drive that reads from or writes to a removable, nonvolatile magnetic disk, and an optical disk drive that reads from or writes to a removable, nonvolatile optical disk such as a CD ROM, DVD, and Blu-Ray® disk, or other optical media. Computer-readable storage media **522** may include, but is not limited to, Zip® drives, flash memory cards, universal serial bus (USB) flash drives, secure digital (SD) cards, DVD disks, digital video tape, and the like. Computer-readable storage media **522** may also include, solid-state drives (SSD) based on non-volatile memory such as flash-memory based SSDs, enterprise flash drives, solid state ROM, and the like, SSDs based on volatile memory such as solid state RAM, dynamic RAM, static RAM, DRAM-based SSDs, magnetoresistive RAM (MRAM) SSDs, and hybrid SSDs that use a combination of DRAM and flash memory based SSDs. The disk drives and their associated computer-readable media may provide non-volatile storage of computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, and other data for computer system **500**.

(86) Machine-readable instructions executable by one or more processors or cores of processing unit **504** may be stored on a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium can include physically tangible memory or storage devices that include volatile memory storage devices and/or non-volatile storage devices. Examples of non-transitory computer-readable storage medium include magnetic storage media (e.g., disk or tapes), optical storage media (e.g., DVDs, CDs), various types of RAM, ROM, or flash memory, hard drives, floppy drives, detachable memory drives (e.g., USB drives), or other type of storage device.

(87) Communications subsystem **524** provides an interface to other computer systems and networks. Communications subsystem **524** serves as an interface for receiving data from and transmitting data to other systems from computer system **500**. For example, communications subsystem **524** may enable computer system **500** to connect to one or more devices via the Internet. In some embodiments communications subsystem **524** can include radio frequency (RF) transceiver components for accessing wireless voice and/or data networks (e.g., using cellular **26** telephone technology, advanced data network technology, such as 3G, 4G or EDGE (enhanced data rates for global evolution), WiFi (IEEE 702.11 family standards, or other mobile communication technologies, or any combination thereof), global positioning system (GPS) receiver components, and/or other components. In some embodiments communications subsystem **524** can provide wired network connectivity (e.g., Ethernet) in addition to or instead of a wireless interface.

(88) In some embodiments, communications subsystem **524** may also receive input communication in the form of structured and/or unstructured data feeds **526**, event streams **528**, event updates **530**, and the like on behalf of one or more users who may use computer system **500**.

(89) By way of example, communications subsystem **524** may be configured to receive data feeds **526** in real-time from users of social networks and/or other communication services such as Twitter® feeds, Facebook® updates, web feeds such as Rich Site Summary (RSS) feeds, and/or real-time updates from one or more third party information sources.

(90) Additionally, communications subsystem **524** may also be configured to receive data in the form of continuous data streams, which may include event streams **528** of real-time events and/or event updates **530**, that may be continuous or unbounded in nature with no explicit end. Examples of applications that generate continuous data may include, for example, sensor data applications, financial tickers, network performance measuring tools (e.g., network monitoring and traffic management applications), clickstream analysis tools, automobile traffic monitoring, and the like.

(91) Communications subsystem **524** may also be configured to output the structured and/or unstructured data feeds **526**, event streams **528**, event updates **530**, and the like to one or more databases that may be in communication with one or more streaming data source computers

coupled to computer system **500**.

(92) Computer system **500** can be one of various types, including a handheld portable device (e.g., an iPhone® cellular phone, an iPad® computing tablet, a PDA), a wearable device (e.g., a Google Glass® head mounted display), a PC, a workstation, a mainframe, a kiosk, a server rack, or any other data processing system.

(93) Due to the ever-changing nature of computers and networks, the description of computer system **500** depicted in FIG. **5** is intended only as a specific example. Many other configurations having more or fewer components than the system depicted in FIG. **5** are possible. For example, customized hardware might also be used and/or particular elements might be implemented in hardware, firmware, software (including applets), or a combination. Further, connection to other computing devices, such as network input/output devices, may be employed. Based on the disclosure and teachings provided herein, a person of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate other ways and/or methods to implement the various embodiments.

4. Architectural Overview

(94) FIGS. **6A-6D** illustrate one example of a system **600** in accordance with one or more embodiments. The system **600** described with reference to FIGS. **6A-6D** may include architecture that performs operations associated with aggregating CA certificates as described herein, distributing aggregate sets of CA certificates, and/or utilizing the CA certificates to authenticate entity certificates, as respectively described herein. The system **600** may also perform operations associated with distributing certificate bundles that include sets of CA certificates to network entities as described herein. Example CA certificates and example entity certificates are further described below in Section **6**, “Authenticating Network Entities.”

(95) A. Trust Zone Architecture.

(96) As illustrated in FIG. **6A**, the system **600** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, and a plurality of trust zones **604** that respectively include all or a portion of the one or more virtual cloud networks **602**. In one example, the system **600** may include one or more regions **606**. The one or more regions **606** may respectively include one or more trust zones **604**. A trust zone may be delineated by a trust zone boundary **608**.

(97) As used herein, the term “trust zone” refers to a portion of a cloud computing environment within which a particular CA issues entity certificates to network entities. The particular CA associated with a trust zone is trusted by the network entities located in the trust zone based on the network entities having access to a CA certificate of the particular CA that may be used to authenticate the particular CA. The particular CA may be untrusted by network entities located outside the trust zone as a result of those network entities lacking the CA certificate necessary to authenticate the particular CA. A cloud computing environment may include a plurality of trust zones. A trust zone may correspond to a region. In one example, a regional CA may issue entity certificates to network entities within the region. Additionally, or in the alternative, a trust zone may correspond to a virtual cloud network. In one example, a network CA may issue entity certificates to network entities located in the virtual cloud network. Additionally, or in the alternative, a trust zone may correspond to an availability domain. In one example, a domain CA may issue entity certificates to network entities within the availability domain. Additionally, or in the alternative, a trust zone may correspond to a fault domain. In one example, a domain CA may issue entity certificates to network entities within the fault domain.

(98) As used herein, the term “trust zone boundary” refers to a logical or physical boundary that defines a boundary of a trust zone. In one example, a trust zone boundary may correspond to a boundary of a region. In one example, a trust zone boundary may correspond to a boundary of virtual cloud network. In one example, a trust zone boundary may correspond to a boundary of an availability domain. In one example, a trust zone boundary may correspond to a boundary of a fault domain.

(99) As used herein, the term “region” refers to a set of one or more interconnected data centers

upon which one or more virtual cloud networks may be deployed. In one example, a region may correspond to a physical geographic area. In one example, a region may correspond to multiple physical geographic areas and/or a portion of a physical geographic area.

(100) In one example, a trust zone boundary **608** may correspond to a region boundary **610**. As used herein, the term “region boundary” refers to a logical or physical boundary that defines a boundary of a region. As shown in FIG. 6A, trust zone **604a**, delineated by trust zone boundary **608a**, may correspond to and/or encompass region **606a**, delineated by region boundary **610a**. Region **606a** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602a** and virtual cloud network **602b**. As further shown, trust zone **604b**, delineated by trust zone boundary **608b**, may correspond to and/or encompass region **606b**, delineated by region boundary **610b**. Region **606b** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602c** and virtual cloud network **602d**.

(101) In one example, a region **606** may include one or more trust zones **604**. A region boundary **610**, delineating a region **606**, may encompass the one or more trust zones **604**. For example, as shown in FIG. 6A, region **606n**, delineated by region boundary **610n**, may include trust zone **604c** (delineated by trust zone boundary **608c**) and trust zone **604d** (delineated by trust zone boundary **608d**). Trust zone **604c** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602e** and virtual cloud network **602f**. The one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602e** and/or virtual cloud network **602f**, may be encompassed by the trust zone boundary **608c**. Trust zone **604d** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602g** and virtual cloud network **602h**. The one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602g** and/or virtual cloud network **602h**, may be encompassed by the trust zone boundary **608d**.

(102) In one example, a virtual cloud network **602** may include one or more trust zones **604**. A virtual cloud network boundary **612**, delineating a virtual cloud network **602**, may encompass the one or more trust zones **604**. As used herein, the term “virtual cloud network boundary” or “VCN boundary” refers to a logical or physical boundary that defines a boundary of a virtual cloud network.

(103) As shown in FIG. 6A, virtual cloud network **602n**, delineated by virtual cloud network boundary **612**, may include trust zone **604e** (delineated by trust zone boundary **608e**) and trust zone **604n** (delineated by trust zone boundary **608n**). Trust zone **604e** may include one or more network entities **614**, such as network entity **614a** and network entity **614b**. The one or more network entities **614**, such as network entity **614a** and/or network entity **614b**, may be encompassed by the trust zone boundary **608c**. Trust zone **604n** may include one or more network entities **614**, such as network entity **614c** and network entity **614n**. The one or more network entities **614**, such as network entity **614c** and/or network entity **614n**, may be encompassed by the trust zone boundary **608n**.

(104) In one example, a trust zone **604** that encompasses a portion of a virtual cloud network **602** may include one or more network entities **614** that share an availability domain. The trust zone boundary **608** may correspond to a boundary of the availability domain. As used herein, the term “availability domain” refers to a physically separate portion of a virtual cloud network with respect to one or more failure modes.

(105) In one example, a trust zone **604** that encompasses a portion of a virtual cloud network **602** may include one or more network entities **614** that share a fault domain. The trust zone boundary **608** may correspond to a boundary of the fault domain. As used herein, the term “fault domain” refers to a portion of a virtual cloud network that has a single point of failure.

(106) B. Certificate Authority Services.

(107) Referring now to FIG. 6B, architecture and operations associated with aggregating CA certificates are further described. As shown in FIG. 6B, the system **600** may include an interzone CA **616** and an interzone CA service **618**. The interzone CA **616** and/or the interzone CA service

618 may be located on a virtual cloud network **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602a**. The system **600** may include at least one virtual cloud network **602** that has an interzone CA **616** and an interzone CA service **618**. In one example, the interzone CA **616** and the interzone CA service **618** may be located on a home VCN **620**. For example, virtual cloud network **602a** may be a home VCN **620**. The home VCN **620** may be located in a home region **622**. For example, region **606a** may be a home region **622**. A trust zone **604**, such as trust zone **604a**, may encompass the home VCN **620**. A trust zone **604**, such as trust zone **604a**, that encompasses a home VCN **620** may be referred to as a home trust zone **624**. The trust zone **604a** may have a trust zone boundary **608a** that corresponds to region boundary **610a** of region **606a**.

(108) As further shown in FIG. **6B**, the system **600** may include an intrazone CA **626** and an intrazone CA service **628**. The intrazone CA **626** and/or the intrazone CA service **628** may be located on a virtual cloud network **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602b**. The system **600** may include one or more virtual cloud networks **602** that have an intrazone CA **626** and an intrazone CA service **628**. In one example, an intrazone CA **626** and an intrazone CA service **628** may be located on each virtual cloud network **602**, such as virtual cloud network **602a** and virtual cloud network **602b**. In one example, an intrazone CA **626** and an intrazone CA service **628** may be located on an ancillary VCN **630**. For example, virtual cloud network **602b** may be an ancillary VCN **630**. The ancillary VCN **630** may be located in an ancillary region **632**. For example, region **606b** may be an ancillary region **632**. A trust zone **604**, such as trust zone **604b**, may encompass the ancillary VCN **630**. A trust zone **604**, such as trust zone **604b**, that encompasses an ancillary VCN **630** may be referred to as an ancillary trust zone **634**. The trust zone **604b** may have a trust zone boundary **608b** that corresponds to region boundary **610b** of region **606b**.

(109) As used herein, the term “home region” refers to a region of a cloud computing environment from which a virtual cloud infrastructure is deployed and/or managed. In one example, a home region may deploy and/or manage virtual cloud infrastructure associated with an interzone CA **616** and/or interzone CA services **618**.

(110) As used herein, the term “home VCN” refers to a virtual cloud network **602** within a home region. In one example, virtual cloud infrastructure may be deployed and/or managed from a home VCN. For example, an interzone CA **616** and/or interzone CA services **618** may be deployed and/or managed from a home VCN. A home region **622** and/or a home VCN **620** may serve as an initial location for deploying cloud computing resources and services, such as ancillary regions **632** and/or ancillary virtual cloud networks **630**.

(111) As used herein, the term “ancillary region” refers to a region of a cloud computing environment that utilizes and/or relies on a home region and/or a home VCN for deployment and/or management of at least a portion of a virtual cloud infrastructure with respect to one or more virtual cloud networks within the region. In one example, an ancillary region may rely on a home region and/or a home VCN for deployment and/or management of an interzone CA **616** and/or interzone CA services **618**.

(112) As used herein, the term “ancillary VCN” refers to a virtual cloud network **602** that is not a home VCN. An ancillary VCN may be located in an ancillary region **632** or a home region **622**. In one example, an ancillary VCN **630** may utilize and/or rely on a home VCN **620** and/or a home region **622** for deployment and/or management of at least a portion of a virtual cloud infrastructure, such as deployment and/or management of an interzone CA **616** and/or interzone CA services **618**.

(113) Referring further to FIG. **6B**, an interzone CA **616** may issue digital certificates for use with respect to interzone security protocols, such as for authentication of network entities from different trust zones. The digital certificates issued by the interzone CA **616** may include CA certificates and/or entity certificates. A CA certificate issued by an interzone CA **616** may be referred to herein as an interzone CA certificate. An entity certificate issued by an interzone CA **616** may be referred to herein as an interzone entity certificate. An interzone CA certificate may be used to authenticate an interzone entity certificate. The interzone CA **616** may issue interzone entity certificates to

network entities that communicate and/or exchange data with network entities from one or more different trust zones. An interzone CA service **618** may perform operations associated with the interzone CA **616** as described herein.

(114) An intrazone CA **626** may issue digital certificates for use with respect to intrazone security protocols, such as for authentication of network entities within a trust zone corresponding to the intrazone CA **626**. The digital certificates issued by the intrazone CA **626** may include CA certificates and/or entity certificates. A CA certificate issued by an intrazone CA **626** may be referred to herein as an intrazone CA certificate. An entity certificate issued by an intrazone CA **626** may be referred to herein as an intrazone entity certificate. An intrazone CA certificate may be used to authenticate an intrazone entity certificate. The intrazone CA **626** may issue intrazone entity certificates to network entities that communicate and/or exchange data with network entities within the same trust zone as one another. An intrazone CA service **628** may perform operations associated with the intrazone CA **626** as described herein.

(115) In one example, a home VCN **620**, such as virtual cloud network **602a**, may include both an interzone CA **616** and an intrazone CA **626**. Additionally, a home VCN **620**, such as virtual cloud network **602a**, may include both an interzone CA service **618** and an intrazone CA service **628**. An intrazone CA **626** located on a home VCN **620** may issue digital certificates for use with respect to intrazone security protocols within a trust zone corresponding to the home VCN **620**. An intrazone CA service **628** located on a home VCN **620** may perform operations associated with the intrazone CA **626** with respect to the trust zone corresponding to the home VCN **620** as described herein.

(116) As shown in FIG. 6B with respect to virtual cloud network **602a**, a virtual cloud network **602**, such as a home VCN **620**, may include an interzone certificate repository **636** and an interzone distribution service **638**. The interzone CA service **618** may store interzone digital certificates in the interzone certificate repository **636**. The interzone distribution service **638** may retrieve interzone digital certificates from the interzone certificate repository **636** and distribute the interzone digital certificates to one or more interzone network entities **640**, such as interzone network entity **640a** and interzone network entity **640n**, located on the virtual cloud network **602a**. The interzone digital certificates stored in the interzone certificate repository **636** by the interzone CA service **618** may include interzone CA certificates and/or interzone entity certificates. The interzone CA **616** may generate the interzone CA certificates and/or interzone entity certificates stored in the interzone certificate repository **636** by the interzone CA service **618**. The interzone digital certificates retrieved by the interzone distribution service **638** and distributed to the one or more interzone network entities **640** may include the interzone CA certificates and/or the interzone entity certificates.

(117) As shown in FIG. 6B with respect to virtual cloud network **602b**, a virtual cloud network **602**, such as an ancillary VCN **630**, may include an intrazone certificate repository **642** and an intrazone distribution service **644** (e.g., intrazone distribution service **644b**). The intrazone CA service **628** may store intrazone digital certificates in the intrazone certificate repository **642**. The intrazone distribution service **644b** may retrieve intrazone digital certificates from the intrazone certificate repository **642** and distribute the intrazone digital certificates to one or more intrazone network entities **646**, such as intrazone network entity **646a** and intrazone network entity **646n**, located on the virtual cloud network **602b**. The intrazone digital certificates stored in the intrazone certificate repository **642** by the intrazone CA service **628** may include intrazone CA certificates and/or intrazone entity certificates. The intrazone CA **626** may generate the intrazone CA certificates and/or intrazone entity certificates stored in the intrazone certificate repository **642** by the intrazone CA service **628**. The intrazone digital certificates retrieved by the intrazone distribution service **644b** and distributed to the one or more intrazone network entities **646** may include the intrazone CA certificates and/or the intrazone entity certificates.

(118) In one example, as shown in FIG. 6B with respect to virtual cloud network **602a**, a virtual cloud network **602**, such as a home VCN **620**, may include an intrazone distribution service **644**,

such as intrazone distribution service **644n**. The virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**, may include the intrazone distribution service **644n** in addition, or in the alternative, to the interzone distribution service **638**. Additionally, virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**, may include an intrazone CA and/or an intrazone CA service. An intrazone CA associated with virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**, may generate intrazone digital certificates. The intrazone digital certificates may be distributed to network entities, such as intrazone network entities, located in virtual cloud network **602a**. In one example, virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**, may include an intrazone certificate repository. An intrazone CA service associated with virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**, may store intrazone digital certificates in the intrazone certificate repository. In one example, intrazone distribution service **644n** may retrieve intrazone digital certificates, such as intrazone CA certificates and/or intrazone entity certificates, from the intrazone certificate repository and distribute the intrazone digital certificates to one or more intrazone network entities located on the virtual cloud network **602a**, such as home VCN **620**.

(119) A certificate repository, such as an interzone certificate repository **636** and/or an intrazone certificate repository **642**, may include a storage medium or other physical hardware associated with the virtual cloud network. A certificate repository may include any type of storage unit and/or device (e.g., a file system, database, collection of tables, or any other storage mechanism) for storing data. Further, a certificate repository may include multiple different storage units and/or devices. The multiple different storage units and/or devices may or may not be of the same type or located at the same physical site. Further, a certificate repository may be implemented or executed on the same computing system as a CA service, a distribution service, and/or one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, a certificate repository may be implemented or executed on a computing system separate from a CA service, a distribution service, and/or one or more network entities. A certificate repository may be communicatively coupled to a CA service, a distribution service, and/or one or more network entities, via a direct connection or via a network.

(120) C. Aggregating Sets of CA Certificates.

(121) Referring further to FIG. **6B**, the system **600** may include a plurality of certificate publishers **648** and a plurality of certificate aggregators **650**. A certificate publisher **648** may identify a set of one or more digital certificates generated by a CA and publish the set of one or more digital certificates to a certificate repository. A certificate aggregator **650** may identify a first set of one or more digital certificates published to a certificate repository and aggregate the first set of one or more digital certificates with a second set of one or more digital certificates in a second certificate repository.

(122) In one example, a certificate publisher **648** may be associated with one or more CAs and/or one or more CA services. A particular certificate publisher **648** may be associated with a particular CA and/or a particular CA service. Each CA and/or each CA service may have its own certificate publisher **648**. As shown in FIG. **6B**, certificate publisher **648a** may be associated with the interzone CA **616** and/or the interzone CA service **618**. As further shown, certificate publisher **648b** may be associated with the intrazone CA **626** and/or the intrazone CA service **628**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a particular certificate publisher **648** may be associated with a particular trust zone. Each trust zone may include one or more certificate publishers **648**. As shown in FIG. **6B**, certificate publisher **648a** may be associated with trust zone **604a**. As further shown, certificate publisher **648b** may be associated with trust zone **604b**.

(123) In one example, a certificate aggregator **650** may be associated with one or more CAs and/or one or more CA services. A particular certificate aggregator **650** may be associated with a particular CA and/or a particular CA service. Each CA and/or each CA service may have its own certificate aggregator **650**. As shown in FIG. **6B**, certificate aggregator **650a** may be associated with the interzone CA **616** and/or the interzone CA service **618**. As further shown, certificate aggregator **650b** may be associated with the intrazone CA **626** and/or the intrazone CA service **628**.

Additionally, or in the alternative, a particular certificate aggregator **650** may be associated with a particular trust zone. Each trust zone may include one or more certificate aggregators **650**. As shown in FIG. **6B**, certificate aggregator **650a** may be associated with trust zone **604a**. As further shown, certificate aggregator **650a** may be associated with trust zone **604b**.

(124) i. Aggregating Sets of Intrazone CA Certificates.

(125) Referring further to FIG. **6B**, in one example, sets of CA certificates issued by CAs associated with different trust zones **604** may be aggregated in an interzone certificate repository **636**. The sets of CA certificates may include intrazone CA certificates issued by intrazone CAs. The sets of CA certificates aggregated in the interzone certificate repository **636** may be distributed for access by one or more sets of network entities. The one or more sets of network entities may be respectively associated with a different trust zone.

(126) In one example, a plurality of certificate aggregators **650** respectively associated with a particular intrazone CA **626** and/or a particular intrazone CA service **628** may obtain and/or receive a set of one or more CA certificates from a particular intrazone certificate repository **642** associated with the particular intrazone CA **626** and/or the particular intrazone CA service **628** and may transmit the set of one or more CA certificates to an interzone certificate repository **636**. A certificate aggregator **650** may obtain the set of one or more CA certificates by generating a copy, or replicating, the set of one or more CA certificates. Additionally, or in the alternative, the certificate aggregator **650** may receive a copy, or a replication, of the set of one or more CA certificates, generated, for example, by a certificate publisher **648**. The set of one or more CA certificates obtained from a particular intrazone certificate repository **642** may have been issued by the particular intrazone CA **626** associated with the particular certificate aggregator **650**. The plurality of certificate publishers **648** may be respectively associated with a particular trust zone **604**. Each particular trust zone may include a plurality of network entities. A particular intrazone CA **626** associated with a particular trust zone **604** may be trusted by a set of one or more network entities located in the trust zone **604**. The interzone certificate repository **636** may be associated with a particular trust zone **604** that differs with respect to at least one of the trust zones **604** associated with an intrazone CA **626** and/or an intrazone CA service **628**.

(127) In one example, a first certificate aggregator **650** associated with a first intrazone CA service may obtain and/or receive a first set of one or more CA certificates and transmit the first set of one or more CA certificates to the interzone certificate repository **636**. The first set of one or more CA certificates may have been issued by a first intrazone CA located in a first trust zone. The first trust zone may include a first set of one or more network entities. The first intrazone CA may be trusted by the first set of one or more network entities. Additionally, a second certificate aggregator **650** associated with a second intrazone CA service may obtain and/or receive a second set of one or more CA certificates and transmit the second set of one or more CA certificates to the interzone certificate repository **636**. The second set of one or more CA certificates may have been issued by a second intrazone CA located in a second trust zone. The second trust zone may include a second set of one or more network entities. The second intrazone CA may be trusted by the second set of one or more network entities. The first certificate aggregator **650** and the second certificate aggregator **650** may aggregate the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates in the interzone certificate repository **636**. The interzone certificate repository **636** may receive the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates, and may store an aggregate set of CA certificates in the interzone certificate repository **636** that includes the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates. A plurality of sets of CA certificates respectively associated with a different CA service and/or a different trust zone may be aggregated in the interzone certificate repository **636**.

(128) In one example, an interzone distribution service **638** may utilize the aggregate set of CA certificates to initially provision a set of interzone network entities **640**. Additionally, or in the alternative, the interzone distribution service **638** may utilize the aggregate set of CA certificates to

update a set of interzone network entities **640**. The initial provisioning and/or updating of the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** may include configuring the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** to communicate and/or exchange data with one or more additional sets of network entities in accordance with a security protocol. The set of one or more interzone network entities **640** and the one or more additional sets of network entities may be respectively associated with a different trust zone. For example, the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data with at least one set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** in accordance with an intrazone security protocol.

Additionally, or in the alternative, the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data with least one additional set of one or more interzone network entities in accordance with an interzone security protocol.

(129) The initial provisioning and/or updating of the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** may include receiving entity certificates from one or more sets of network entities with respect to which the set of one or more interzone network entities **640** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data, and authenticating the entity certificates via the aggregate set of CA certificates. In one example, interzone distribution service **638** may receive a first set of one or more entity certificates from a first set of one or more network entities. The interzone distribution service **638** may authenticate the first set of one or more entity certificates via a first set of one or more CA certificates included in the aggregate set of CA certificates. The first set of one or more entity certificates may have been issued to the first set of one or more network entities by a first intrazone CA that is trusted by the first set of one or more network entities. The interzone distribution service **638** and the first intrazone CA may be respectively associated with a different trust zone. In one example, interzone distribution service **638** may receive a second set of one or more entity certificates from a second set of one or more network entities. The interzone distribution service **638** may authenticate the second set of one or more entity certificates via a second set of one or more CA certificates included in the aggregate set of CA certificates. The second set of one or more entity certificates may have been issued to the second set of one or more network entities by a second intrazone CA that is trusted by the second set of one or more network entities. The interzone distribution service **638** and the second intrazone CA may be respectively associated with a different trust zone.

(130) Referring further to FIG. **6B**, in one example, a certificate repository **642** may include a distribution bucket **652**. Digital certificates that are distributed for access by network entities may be stored in the distribution bucket **652**. In one example, with reference to virtual cloud network **602a**, interzone certificate repository **636** may include distribution bucket **652a**. Interzone distribution service **638** may distribute digital certificates to interzone network entities **640** from distribution bucket **652a**. In one example, with reference to virtual cloud network **602b**, intrazone certificate repository **642** may include distribution bucket **652b**. Intrazone distribution service **644** may distribute digital certificates to intrazone network entities **646** from distribution bucket **652b**. In one example, a certificate publisher **648b** associated with an intrazone CA service **628** may publish digital certificates to distribution bucket **652b**. In one example, a certificate aggregator **650b** associated with an intrazone CA service **628** may obtain a set of one or more CA certificates from a distribution bucket **652b** of an intrazone certificate repository **642** and may transmit the set of one or more CA certificates to an interzone certificate repository **636**. A plurality of sets of one or more CA certificates may be transmitted to, and stored in, the interzone certificate repository **636**, for example, by a plurality of different certificate aggregators **650b**.

(131) In one example, with reference to virtual cloud network **602a**, an interzone certificate repository **636** may include an aggregate bucket **654**. CA certificates transmitted to the interzone certificate repository **636** by various certificate aggregators **650b** may be stored in the aggregate bucket **654**. In one example, a certificate aggregator **650a** associated with an interzone CA service **618** may obtain sets of CA certificates stored in the aggregate bucket **654** and generate an aggregate

set of CA certificates that includes the sets of CA certificates obtained from the aggregate bucket **654**. The certificate aggregator **650a** associated with the interzone CA service **618** may store the aggregate set of CA certificates in the distribution bucket **652a** of the interzone certificate repository **636**. The interzone distribution service **638** may distribute the aggregate set of CA certificates from the distribution bucket **652a** to one or more interzone network entities **640a**. The aggregate set of CA certificates may be utilized by the one or more interzone network entities **640a** to authenticate network entities, such as intrazone network entities **646**, from different trust zones.

(132) ii. Aggregating Sets of Intrazone CA Certificates with Sets of Interzone CA Certificates.

(133) Referring further to FIG. **6B**, in one example, an interzone CA **616** may generate interzone CA certificates that may be utilized by network entities to authenticate interzone entity certificates issued by the interzone CA **616** to interzone network entities **640**. In one example, the interzone CA certificates may be transmitted to different trust zones **604** and distributed to one or more network entities, such as intrazone network entities **646**, located in the different trust zones. The network entities, such as the intrazone network entities **646**, may utilize the interzone CA certificates to authenticate interzone entity certificates issued to the interzone network entities **640** by the interzone CA **616**. In one example, a certificate publisher **648a** associated with an interzone CA **616** may publish sets of one or more interzone CA certificates to the interzone certificate repository **636**. The interzone certificate repository may include an interzone bucket **656**. The sets of one or more interzone CA certificates published to the interzone certificate repository **636** by the certificate publisher **648a** may be stored in the interzone bucket **656**.

(134) In one example, one or more certificate aggregators **650b** respectively associated with a particular intrazone CA service **628** and/or a particular trust zone **604** may obtain a set of one or more interzone CA certificates from the interzone certificate repository **636**, such as from the interzone bucket **656**. A certificate aggregator **650b** that obtains a set of one or more interzone CA certificates from the interzone certificate repository **636** may store the set of one or more interzone CA certificates in an intrazone certificate repository **642** associated with the particular intrazone CA service **628** and/or the particular trust zone **604** corresponding to the certificate aggregator **650b**. For example, the certificate aggregator **650b** may store the set of one or more interzone CA certificates in the distribution bucket **652b** of the intrazone certificate repository **642**. The set of one or more interzone CA certificates may be aggregated with a set of one or more intrazone CA certificates generated by an intrazone CA **626**. An aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the set of one or more interzone CA certificates and the set of one or more intrazone CA certificates may be distributed for access by one or more network entities at least by storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in the intrazone certificate repository **642**. The intrazone distribution service **644b** may obtain the aggregate set of CA certificates from the intrazone certificate repository **642**, such as from the distribution bucket **652b**, and may distribute the aggregate set of CA certificates to one or more intrazone network entities.

(135) In one example, a first certificate aggregator **650a** associated with an interzone CA service **618** may obtain and/or receive a first set of one or more interzone CA certificates from an interzone certificate repository **636**, such as from an interzone bucket **656** of the interzone certificate repository. The first certificate aggregator **650a** may transmit the first set of one or more interzone CA certificates to an intrazone certificate repository **642**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a second certificate aggregator **650b** associated with an intrazone CA service **628** may obtain and/or receive the first set of one or more interzone CA certificates from the interzone certificate repository **636**, such as from the interzone bucket **656** of the interzone certificate repository. The second certificate aggregator **650b** may store the first set of one or more interzone CA certificates in the intrazone certificate repository **642**, such as in the distribution bucket **652b** of the intrazone certificate repository **642**. The first set of one or more interzone CA certificates may have been issued by an interzone CA **616** located in a first trust zone **604a**. The first trust zone **604a** may include a first set of one or more network entities, such as a first set of one or more interzone

network entities **640**. The first interzone CA **616** may be trusted by the first set of one or more network entities, such as a first set of one or more interzone network entities **640**. Additionally, a certificate publisher **648b** associated with the intrazone CA service **628** may publish a second set of one or more intrazone CA certificates to the intrazone certificate repository **642**, such as to the distribution bucket **652b** of the intrazone certificate repository **642**. The second set of one or more intrazone CA certificates may have been issued by an intrazone CA **626** located in a second trust zone **604b**. The second trust zone **604b** may include a second set of one or more network entities, such as a second set of one or more intrazone network entities **646**. The intrazone CA **626** may be trusted by the second set of one or more network entities, such as the second set of one or more intrazone network entities **646**. The first set of one or more interzone CA certificates and the second set of one or more intrazone CA certificates may be aggregated in the intrazone certificate repository **642**, such as in the distribution bucket **652**. The intrazone certificate repository **642**, such as in the distribution bucket **652**, may include an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the first set of one or more interzone CA certificates and the second set of one or more intrazone CA certificates.

(136) In one example, an intrazone distribution service **644b** may utilize the aggregate set of CA certificates to initially provision a set of intrazone network entities **646**. Additionally, or in the alternative, the intrazone distribution service **644b** may utilize the aggregate set of CA certificates to update a set of intrazone network entities **646**. The initial provisioning and/or updating of the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** may include configuring the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** to communicate and/or exchange data with one or more additional sets of network entities in accordance with a security protocol. The set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** and the one or more additional sets of network entities may be respectively associated with a different trust zone. For example, the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data with at least one set of one or more interzone network entities **640** in accordance with an interzone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data with least one additional set of one or more intrazone network entities in accordance with an intrazone security protocol.

(137) The initial provisioning and/or updating of the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** may include receiving entity certificates from one or more sets of network entities with respect to which the set of one or more intrazone network entities **646** may be configured to communicate and/or exchange data, and authenticating the entity certificates via the aggregate set of CA certificates. In one example, intrazone distribution service **644b** may receive a first set of one or more entity certificates from a first set of one or more network entities. The intrazone distribution service **644b** may authenticate the first set of one or more entity certificates via a first set of one or more CA certificates included in the aggregate set of CA certificates. The first set of one or more entity certificates may have been issued to the first set of one or more network entities by an intrazone CA **626** that is trusted by the first set of one or more network entities. The first set of one or more network entities may include a first set of one or more intrazone network entities **646**. The first set of one or more CA certificates may include a first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates. The intrazone distribution service **644b** and the intrazone CA **626** may be respectively associated with the same trust zone, such as trust zone **604b**. In one example, the intrazone distribution service **644b** may receive a second set of one or more entity certificates from a second set of one or more network entities. The intrazone distribution service **644b** may authenticate the second set of one or more entity certificates via a second set of one or more CA certificates included in the aggregate set of CA certificates. The second set of one or more entity certificates may have been issued to the second set of one or more network entities by an interzone CA **616** that is trusted by the second set of one or more network entities. The second set of one or more network entities may include a second set of one or more interzone network entities **640**. The

second set of one or more CA certificates may include a second set of one or more interzone CA certificates. The intrazone distribution service **644b** and the interzone CA **616** may be respectively associated with a different trust zone. For example, the interzone CA **616** may be associated with trust zone **604a**, and the intrazone distribution service **644b** may be associated with trust zone **604b**.

(138) In one example, with reference to virtual cloud network **602a**, an intrazone distribution service **644n** may distribute intrazone CA certificates to one or more network entities, such as one or more interzone network entities **640**. The intrazone CA certificates may be generated by an intrazone CA and stored in an intrazone bucket **658** of a certificate repository. For example, the interzone certificate repository **636** may include an interzone bucket **656** and an intrazone bucket **658**. Interzone CA certificates may be stored in the interzone bucket **656** of the interzone certificate repository **636**. Intrazone CA certificates may be stored in the intrazone bucket **658** of the interzone certificate repository **636**. The interzone distribution service **638** may distribute the interzone CA certificates to one or more network entities, such as one or more interzone network entities. The intrazone distribution service **644n** may distribute the intrazone CA certificates to one or more network entities, such as one or more interzone network entities and/or one or more intrazone network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, the interzone CA certificates and the intrazone CA certificates may be aggregated and stored in the distribution bucket **652a** of the interzone certificate repository **636**.

(139) D. Communications within and Between Trust Zones.

(140) Referring now to FIG. **6C**, architecture and operations associated with aggregating CA certificates are further described. As shown in FIG. **6C**, the system **600** may include a plurality of trust zones **604**, such as trust zone **604a**, trust zone **604b**, and trust zone **604z**. A trust zone **604** may include at least one certificate repository **660**. For example, trust zone **604a** may include certificate repository **660a**, and trust zone **604b** may include certificate repository **660b**. A trust zone **604** may include at least one distribution service **662**. For example, trust zone **604a** may include distribution service **662a**, trust zone **604b** may include distribution service **662b**, and trust zone **604z** may include distribution service **662z**. The distribution service **662** associated with a trust zone **604** may distribute a set of aggregate CA certificates to one or more sets of more network entities **666** located in the trust zone **604**. The one or more sets of network entities **666** may include a set of one or more interzone network entities **668** and/or a set of one or more intrazone network entities **670**. In one example, trust zone **604a** may include a first set of one or more interzone network entities **668** (e.g., interzone network entity **668a** and interzone network entity **668n**) and a first set of one or more intrazone network entities **670** (e.g., intrazone network entity **670a** and intrazone network entity **670n**). In one example, trust zone **604b** may include a second set of one or more intrazone network entities **670** (e.g., intrazone network entity **670b** and intrazone network entity **670y**). In one example, trust zone **604z** may include a second set of one or more interzone network entities **668** (e.g., interzone network entity **668c** and interzone network entity **668z**) and a third set of one or more intrazone network entities **670** (e.g., intrazone network entity **670c** and intrazone network entity **670z**).

(141) The system **600** may be configured for communication and/or data exchange among network entities **666** within and/or between trust zones **604** in accordance with one or more security protocols. Network entities **666** located in the same trust zone may communicate and/or exchange data with one another in accordance with an intrazone security protocol. Network entities **666** located in different trust zones may communicate and/or exchange data with one another in accordance with an interzone security protocol.

(142) i. Example Intrazone Security Protocols.

(143) In one example, an intrazone network entity **670** may communicate and/or exchange data with another network entity **666** located in the same trust zone in accordance with an intrazone security protocol. The intrazone security protocol may include the intrazone network entity **670**

authenticating an entity certificate presented by the other network entity **666** using a CA certificate of a CA that issued the entity certificate to the other network entity **666**. The other network entity **666** authenticated by the intrazone network entity **670** may be another intrazone network entity **670** or an interzone network entity **668**. The CA certificate used by the intrazone network entity **670** to authenticate the entity certificate may be included in the set of aggregate CA certificates distributed to the intrazone network entity **670**.

(144) As shown in FIG. **6C**, with reference to trust zone **604a**, intrazone network entity **670a** may authenticate intrazone network entity **670n** in accordance with the intrazone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, intrazone network entity **670n** may authenticate intrazone network entity **670a** in accordance with the intrazone security protocol. Upon having authenticated one another, intrazone network entity **670a** and intrazone network entity **670n** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another, for example, via an intrazone network connection **672a**.

(145) As further shown in FIG. **6C**, with reference to trust zone **604z**, interzone network entity **668x** may authenticate intrazone network entity **670z** in accordance with the intrazone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, intrazone network entity **670z** may authenticate interzone network entity **668x** in accordance with the intrazone security protocol. Upon having authenticated one another, intrazone network entity **670z** and interzone network entity **668x** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another, for example, via an intrazone network connection **672b**.

(146) ii. Example Interzone Security Protocols.

(147) In one example, an interzone network entity **668** may communicate and/or exchange data with another network entity **666** located in a different trust zone in accordance with an interzone security protocol. The interzone security protocol may include the interzone network entity **668** authenticating an entity certificate presented by the other network entity **666** using a CA certificate of a CA that issued the entity certificate to the other network entity **666**. The other network entity **666** authenticated by the interzone network entity **668** may be another interzone network entity **668** or an intrazone network entity **670**. The CA certificate used by the interzone network entity **668** to authenticate the entity certificate may be included in the set of aggregate CA certificates distributed to the interzone network entity **668**.

(148) As shown in FIG. **6C**, with reference to trust zone **604a** and trust zone **604z**, interzone network entity **668n**, located in trust zone **604a**, may authenticate interzone network entity **668c**, located in trust zone **604z**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, interzone network entity **668c**, located in trust zone **604z**, may authenticate interzone network entity **668n**, located in trust zone **604a**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Upon having authenticated one another, interzone network entity **668n** and interzone network entity **668c** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another across trust zone boundary **608a** and/or trust zone boundary **608z**, for example, via an interzone network connection **674a**.

(149) As further shown in FIG. **6C**, with reference to trust zone **604a** and trust zone **604b**, intrazone network entity **670b**, located in trust zone **604b**, may authenticate interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, may authenticate intrazone network entity **670b**, located in trust zone **604a**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Upon having authenticated one another, intrazone network entity **670b** and interzone network entity **668a** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another across trust zone boundary **608a** and/or trust zone boundary **608b**, for example, via an interzone network connection **674b**.

(150) As further shown in FIG. **6C**, with reference to trust zone **604a** and trust zone **6047**, intrazone network entity **670c**, located in trust zone **604z**, may authenticate interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, may authenticate

intrazone network entity **670c**, located in trust zone **604z**, in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Upon having authenticated one another, intrazone network entity **670c** and interzone network entity **668a** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another across trust zone boundary **608a** and/or trust zone boundary **608z**, for example, via an interzone network connection **674c**.

(151) In one example, an intrazone network entity **670** may communicate and/or exchange data with another intrazone network entity **670** located in a different trust zone upon both intrazone network entities **670** having authenticated with an interzone network entity **668** in accordance with an intrazone security protocol. In one example, the interzone network entity **668** may be an intermediate service host. The intermediate service host may act as an intermediary for authenticating intrazone network entities **670** located in different trust zones **604** from one another.

(152) In one example, the communication and/or exchange of data between the intrazone network entities **670** may be routed through the interzone network entity **668**. For example, the interzone network entity **668** may communicate and/or exchange data with each of the intrazone network entities **670** across at least one trust zone boundary **608** in accordance with the intrazone security protocol. Additionally, or in the alternative, the interzone security protocol may preclude the intrazone network entities **670** located in the different trust zones **604** from communicating and/or exchanging data directly with one another across a trust zone boundary **608**. The intrazone network entities **670** located in the different trust zones **604** may indirectly communicate and/or exchange data with one another across at least one trust zone boundary **608** via the interzone network entity **668** in accordance with the interzone security protocol, for example, upon having authenticated with the interzone network entity **668**. The interzone security protocol may preclude the intrazone network entities **670** located in the different trust zones **604** from communication and/or exchange data with another across a trust zone boundary **608** via the interzone network entity **668** unless the intrazone network entities **670** have authenticated with the interzone network entity **668**.

(153) In one example, intrazone network entities **670** located in different trust zones **604** may communicate and/or exchange data directly with one another across one or more trust zone boundaries **608** upon having authenticated with an interzone network entity **668**, such as an intermediate service host. In one example, upon having authenticated with the interzone network entity **668**, such as the intermediate service host, the intrazone network entities **670** may authenticate with one another in accordance with an interzone security protocol prior to communicating and/or exchanging data directly with one another across one or more trust zone boundaries **608**. The interzone security protocol may preclude the intrazone network entities **670** located in the different trust zones **604** from communication and/or exchange data with one another across one or more trust zone boundaries **608** via the interzone network entity **668** unless the intrazone network entities **670** have authenticated with the interzone network entity **668** and with one another.

(154) As shown in FIG. 6C, intrazone network entity **670b**, located in trust zone **604b**, and interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, may authenticate with one another in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Additionally, intrazone network entity **670c**, located in trust zone **604z**, and interzone network entity **668a**, located in trust zone **604a**, may authenticate with one another in accordance with the interzone security protocol. Upon having respectively authenticated with interzone network entity **668a**, intrazone network entity **670b** and intrazone network entity **670c** may communicate and/or exchange data with one another across one or more trust zone boundaries **608**, for example, indirectly via interzone network entity **668a**, via interzone network connection **674b** and interzone network connection **674c**. Additionally, or in the alternative, upon having respectively authenticated with interzone network entity **668a**, intrazone network entity **670b** and intrazone network entity **670c** may authenticate with one another prior to communicating and/or exchanging data with one another across the one or more trust zone boundaries **608**. Upon having authenticated with one another, intrazone network entity **670b** and

intrazone network entity **670c** may directly or indirectly communicate and/or exchange data with one another across the one or more trust zone boundaries **608**.

(155) In one example, a system **600** may include overlapping trust zones **604**. For example, different CAs may respectively generate CA certificates that may be utilized by overlapping sets of network entities **666** for different purposes. In one example, a network entity **666** may operate as an intrazone network entity **670** in accordance with an intrazone security protocol with respect to a first trust zone **604**. Additionally, the network entity **666** may operate as an interzone network entity **668** in accordance with an interzone security protocol with respect to a second trust zone **604**.

(156) In one example, an intermediate service host may operate as an intrazone network entity **670** in accordance with an intrazone security protocol with respect to a first trust zone **604**, and as an interzone network entity **668** in accordance with an interzone security protocol with respect to a second trust zone **604**.

(157) For example, the intermediate service host may be located in a home region and/or a home VCN. The intermediate service host may communicate and/or exchange data with a first set of one or more network entities **666**, such as one or more intrazone network entities **670**, located in the home region and/or a home VCN in accordance with an intrazone security protocol associated with a first trust zone **604**. The intrazone security protocol may include using a first CA certificate issued by a first CA associated with the first trust zone **604** to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued to the first set of one or more network entities **666**. In one example, the first CA may be an intrazone CA. Additionally, the intermediate service host may communicate and/or exchange data with a second set of one or more network entities **666**, such as one or more interzone network entities **668**, located in the home region and/or the home VCN in accordance with an interzone security protocol associated with a second trust zone **604**. The interzone security protocol may include using a second CA certificate issued by a second CA associated with the second trust zone **604** to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued to the second set of one or more network entities **666**. In one example, the second CA may be an interzone CA. In one example, the intermediate service host may facilitate communications and/or data exchange between a home trust zone and one or more ancillary trust zones, and/or between different ancillary zones, that are authenticated using the second CA certificate of the second CA. Additionally, the intermediate service host may communicate and/or exchange data with network entities **666** located in the home trust zone, that are authenticated using the first CA certificate of the first CA.

(158) In one example, the first CA certificate may be a root CA certificate and the second CA certificate may be an intermediate CA certificate. The intermediate CA certificate may be issued by the first CA based on the root CA certificate. In one example, the intermediate service host may authenticate network entities **666** located in the first trust zone **604** based on entity certificates issued by the first CA based on the root CA certificate. In one example, the intermediate service host may authenticate network entities **666** located in the second trust zone **604** based on entity certificates issued by the second CA based on the intermediate CA certificate.

(159) E. Virtual Cloud Network Architecture.

(160) Referring now to FIG. **6D**, the system **600** is further described with reference to an example virtual cloud network **680**. The virtual cloud network **680** may include or correspond to one or more of the virtual cloud networks **602** described with reference to FIGS. **6A** and/or **6B**. As shown in FIG. **6D**, the virtual cloud network **680** may include a substrate network **681**, an overlay network **682**, and a network interface **683** that provides communication between the substrate network **681** and the overlay network **682**. The system **600** may include a plurality of network entities **684** located throughout the virtual cloud network **680**. The plurality of network entities **684** may correspond to the plurality of network entities described with reference to FIGS. **6A-6C**. A network entity **684** may reside on the substrate network **681**, the overlay network **682**, or the network

interface **683**. A network entity **684** may be implemented in hardware and/or software in association with the virtual cloud network, such as a node, a host, an agent, a service, a component, an endpoint, or other element. The plurality of network entities **684** may include one or more substrate entities **685**, one or more interface entities **686**, and/or one or more overlay entities **687**. (161) As used herein, the term “substrate entity” refers to a network entity **684** implemented in a substrate network **681**. As used herein, the term “substrate network” refers to a physical network infrastructure. The substrate network generally provides a foundation of a virtual cloud network. The substrate network **681** may include physical network devices, such as routers, switches, network links, and other networking components. The substrate network **681** may generally provide the basic connectivity and transport capabilities necessary for data transmission within and between data centers.

(162) The one or more substrate entities **685** may include substrate hosts, routers, firewall appliances, load balancers, storage devices, and/or substrate services. A substrate host may include an endpoint within the substrate network **681**, such as a bare metal host, a virtual machine, a container, or a physical server. A substrate service may include a service executing or executable on a substrate entity, such as a firmware service, a network connectivity service, an addressing service, a name resolution service, a security service, a network monitoring service, a load balancing service, and/or a storage service. A firmware service may be associated with functionality or management of network infrastructure components or services, such as network devices, boot-up or initialization process, hardware controls, feature enablement, updates, hardware abstraction, network configuration, and/or network management. In one example, a substrate entity **685** may include a combination of hardware and software. In one example, the one or more substrate entities **685** may include one or more substrate hosts, and/or one or more substrate services. In one example, a substrate host may include a bare metal host. In one example, a substrate service may include a firmware service. The substrate entities **685** may communicate with one another, and/or with other network entities **684**, using logical network addresses assigned within the overlay network.

(163) As used herein, the term “network interface” refers to a communication interface between a substrate network and an overlay network, such as a network interface card, a smartNIC, or the like. A network interface **683** may include one or more interface entities **686**, such as a node on the network interface **683**, or an interface service executing or executable on the network interface **683**. A node on the network interface **683** may include a programmable hardware component, a memory component, or a gateway component. In one example, a network interface **683** may include a network interface card, such as a smartNIC. Additionally, or in the alternative, a network interface **683** may include a node or an endpoint on a network interface card or smartNIC.

(164) A gateway component may provide connectivity between the substrate network **681** and the network interface **683**, and/or between the network interface **683** and the overlay network **682**. For example, a gateway component may enable communication between overlay entities **687** and substrate entities **685**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a gateway component may provide connectivity between the overlay network **682** and external networks, such as the internet or other networks outside the overlay network. For example, an overlay gateway may enable communication between overlay entities **687** and external endpoints.

(165) As used herein, the term “overlay network” refers to a virtual network built on a substrate network using software-defined networking (SDN), virtualization, tunneling, and/or encapsulation technologies. An overlay network generally operates independently of the underlying substrate network. An overlay network may provide logical separation and isolation of traffic, enable virtual network provisioning, and/or allow for implementation of various network services and policies. Virtual machines, hosts, containers, or virtual network functions running on a substrate network may be connected via an overlay network.

(166) As used herein, the term “overlay entity” refers to a network entity **684** implemented on an

overlay network **682**. The overlay network **682** may include a plurality of overlay entities **687**. The plurality of overlay entities **687** may include overlay hosts, overlay services, subnets, overlay controllers, and/or overlay clients. In one example, the overlay network **682** may include a plurality of overlay entities **687**, such as overlay entity **687c** and overlay entity **687n**. In one example, an overlay entity **687** may include an overlay host. Additionally, or in the alternative, an overlay entity **687** may include an overlay service. The plurality of overlay entities **687** may communicate with one another using logical network addresses assigned within the overlay network **682**.

(167) An overlay host may include an endpoint within the overlay network **682**, such as a virtual machine, a container, or a physical server. An overlay service may include a service executing or executable on an overlay entity. An overlay service may include a client-specific service, such as a service installed by a client. Additionally, or in the alternative, an overlay service may include a virtual network creation service, a virtual network management service, a virtual machine orchestration service, a container orchestration service, a network virtualization service, an overlay security service, a load balancing service, a multi-tenancy service, and/or a tenant isolation service.

(168) A subnet may include a virtual network segment that has a distinct addressing scheme and/or a distinct set of network policies and/or services. A subnet may include a set of overlay hosts. Multiple subnets may be utilized to partition respective sets of overlay hosts. An overlay controller may oversee management, control, provisioning, configuration, and/or monitoring of an overlay network, network entities on the overlay network, and/or network policies within the overlay. An overlay controller interact with the underlying substrate network, for example, to coordinate the operation of overlay hosts and/or communications across virtual switches and tunnels. An overlay client may include an endpoint or device that initiates communication within the overlay network. An overlay client may be a specific instance or role within an overlay host. An overlay host may include a set of overlay clients. An overlay client may include a consumer or user of services provided by overlay hosts or the IaaS. An overlay client may request and consume resources or services from overlay hosts, acting as consumers or clients of those resources or services.

(169) Referring further to FIG. **6D**, the system **600** may include at least one distribution service **688** and at least one certificate repository **689**. The at least one distribution service **688** may correspond to a distribution service described with reference to FIGS. **6A-6C**. A distribution service **688** may be configured to distribute certificate bundles to at least some of the network entities **684**. The certificate bundles may be housed in a certificate repository **689** accessible by the distribution service **688**. The certificate repository **689** may correspond to a certificate repository described with reference to FIGS. **6A-6C**. The distribution service **688** may retrieve a certificate bundle from the certificate repository **689** and transmit the certificate bundle to one or more of the network entities **684**.

(170) In one example, a first distribution service **688a** may be implemented on the substrate network **681**. A distribution service **688** implemented on the substrate network **681** may be communicatively coupled with one or more substrate entities **685** on the substrate network **681**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a distribution service **688** implemented on the substrate network **681** may be communicatively coupled with the network interface **683**, such as with one or more interface entities **686** on the network interface **683**. For example, the first distribution service **688a** may obtain certificate bundles from the certificate repository **689** and distribute the certificate bundles to one or more substrate entities **685** on the substrate network **681** and/or to one or more interface entities **686** on the network interface **683**.

(171) In one example, a second distribution service **688b** may be implemented on the network interface **683**. A distribution service **688** implemented on the network interface **683** may be communicatively coupled with the overlay network **682** and/or the substrate network **681**. For example, the second distribution service **688b** implemented on the network interface **683** may be communicatively coupled with one or more overlay entities **687** on the overlay network **682**. The second distribution service **688b** may distribute certificate bundles to one or more overlay entities

687 on the overlay network **682**. In one example, the second distribution service **688b** may obtain certificate bundles from a storage medium associated with the network interface **683**, such as from a storage medium associated with an interface entity **686** on the network interface **683**. For example, the second distribution service **688b** may distribute a certificate bundle that has been installed in the storage medium associated with the network interface **683** and/or the interface entity **686**. In one example, the first distribution service **688a** may distribute a certificate bundle to an interface entity **686** on the network interface **683**, and the second distribution service **688b** may distribute the certificate bundle to one or more overlay entities **687** on the overlay network **682** after the certificate bundle has been installed in the storage medium associated with the interface entity **686**.

(172) As shown in FIG. 6D, each network entity **684** may include a provisioning module **690** and a storage medium **691**. The provisioning module **690** associated with a network entity **684** may receive certificate bundles from the distribution service **688** and install the certificate bundle in the storage medium **691** associated with the network entity **684**. The distribution service **688** may distribute a certificate bundle to the provisioning module **690** in connection with an initial provisioning of the network entity **684** and/or in connection with a periodic update. Additionally, or in the alternative, the distribution service **688** may distribute a certificate bundle to the provisioning module **690** in accordance with a respective phase of a certificate bundle distribution process.

(173) In one example, a provisioning module **690** of an overlay entity **687** may send requests for a certificate bundle to a distribution service **688** by way of a gateway **692** between the network interface **683** and the overlay entities **687**. Additionally, or in the alternative, the distribution service **688** may send the certificate bundles to the overlay entities **687** by way of the gateway **692**, for example, in response to a request from a provisioning module **690**. In one example, the gateway **692** may be a metadata interface configured for exchanging metadata between the network interface **683** and the overlay entities **687**. In one example, the gateway **692** may be utilized between the network interface **683** and each of the overlay entities **687**. Additionally, or in the alternative, the network interface **683** may include a set of gateways **692**, with each gateway **692** corresponding to a respective overlay entity **687**.

(174) The certificate repository **689** may include a storage medium on the substrate network **681** or other physical hardware associated with the virtual cloud network. The certificate repository **689** may include any type of storage unit and/or device (e.g., a file system, database, collection of tables, or any other storage mechanism) for storing data. Further, the certificate repository **689** may include multiple different storage units and/or devices. The multiple different storage units and/or devices may or may not be of the same type or located at the same physical site. Further, the certificate repository **689** may be implemented or executed on the same computing system as the distribution service **688** and/or one or more of the network entities **684**. Additionally, or in the alternative, the certificate repository **689** may be implemented or executed on a computing system separate from the distribution service **688** and/or one or more of the network entities **684**. The certificate repository **689** may be communicatively coupled to the distribution service **688** and/or one or more of the network entities **684** via a direct connection or via a network.

(175) In one or more embodiments, the system **600** may include more or fewer components than the components illustrated in FIGS. 6A-6D. The components illustrated in FIGS. 6A-6D may be local to or remote from each other. The components illustrated in FIGS. 6A-6D may include software and/or hardware components. Each component may be distributed over multiple applications and/or machines. Multiple components may be combined into one application and/or machine. Operations described with respect to one component may instead be performed by another component. Additional embodiments and/or examples relating to the system **600** are described above in Section 2, titled “Cloud Computing Technology”.

(176) In an embodiment, the system **600** may include various components implemented on one or more digital devices. The term “digital device” generally refers to any hardware device that

includes a processor. A digital device may refer to a physical device executing an application or a virtual machine. Examples of digital devices include a computer, a tablet, a laptop, a desktop, a netbook, a server, a web server, a network policy server, a proxy server, a generic machine, a function-specific hardware device, a hardware router, a hardware switch, a hardware firewall, a hardware firewall, a hardware network address translator (NAT), a hardware load balancer, a mainframe, a television, a content receiver, a set-top box, a printer, a mobile handset, a smartphone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a wireless receiver and/or transmitter, a base station, a communication management device, a router, a switch, a controller, an access point, and/or a client device.

(177) Referring further to FIGS. 6A-6D, example trust zones **604** are further described. In one example, a trust zone **604** may include a set of one or more substrate networks **681**. The one or more substrate networks **681** included in a trust zone **604** may be associated with a particular region **606**, a particular virtual cloud network **602**, and/or a particular portion of a virtual cloud network **602**. For example, a first trust zone **604a** may include first set of one or more substrate networks **681**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a second trust zone **604b** may include a second set of one or more substrate networks **681**. The first set of one or more substrate networks **681** of the first trust zone **604** may be associated with at least one of: a first set of one or more regions **606**, a first set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or a first set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**. The second set of one or more substrate networks **681** of the second trust zone **604** may be associated with at least one of: a second set of one or more regions **606**, a second set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or a second set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**.

(178) In one example, a trust zone may include a set of one or more overlay networks **682**. The one or more overlay networks **682** included in a trust zone **604** may be associated with a particular region **606**, a particular virtual cloud network **602**, and/or a particular portion of a virtual cloud network **602**. For example, a first trust zone **604a** may include first set of one or more overlay networks **682**. Additionally, or in the alternative, a second trust zone **604b** may include a second set of one or more overlay networks **682**. The first set of one or more overlay networks **682** of the first trust zone **604** may be associated with at least one of: a first set of one or more regions **606**, a first set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or a first set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**. The second set of one or more overlay networks **682** of the second trust zone **604** may be associated with at least one of: a second set of one or more regions **606**, a second set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or a second set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**.

(179) In one example, a trust zone boundary **608** may separate a set of one or more substrate networks **681** from a set of one or more overlay networks **682**. The set of one or more substrate networks **681** may be associated with a first trust zone **604a** that does not include an overlay network **682**, and the set of one or more overlay networks **682** may be associated with a second trust zone **604b** that does not include a substrate network **681**. The first trust zone **604a** may include each of a plurality of substrate networks **681** corresponding to at least one of: a first set of one or more regions **606**, a first set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or a first set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**. The second trust zone **604b** may include each of a plurality of overlay networks **682** corresponding to at least one of: the first set of one or more regions **606**, the first set of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**, or the first set of one or more portions of one or more virtual cloud networks **602**.

5. Aggregating Certificate Authority Certificates

(180) Referring now to FIG. 7, operations **700** pertaining to validating certificate bundles are further described. The operations **700** described with reference to FIG. 7 may represent at least a portion of a process for distributing certificate bundles to network entities and/or provisioning cloud resource instances, as respectively described herein. One or more operations **700** described

with reference to in FIG. 7 may be modified, combined, rearranged, or omitted all together. Accordingly, the particular sequence of operations **700** described with reference to FIG. 7 should not be construed as limiting the scope of one or more embodiments.

(181) As shown in FIG. 7, the operations **700** may include, at block **702**, receiving a set of CA certificates issued by a CA that is trusted by a particular set of one or more network entities. The CA certificates may be received from a CA service associated with the CA that issued the set of CA certificates. The CA service may be located in a particular trust zone. Additionally, or in the alternative, the particular set of one or more network entities may be located in particular trust zone. At block **704**, the operations **700** may include determining whether there is another set of CA certificates issued by another CA that is trusted by another particular set of one or more network entities. When there is another set of CA certificates, the operations may return to block **702**. At block **704**, when there are no further sets of CA certificates issued by another CA, the operations may proceed to block **706**. At block **706**, the operations **700** may include aggregating the sets of CA certificates in a certificate repository.

(182) At block **708**, the operations **700** may include distributing an aggregate set of CA certificates for access by an additional set of one or more network entities. The aggregate set of CA certificates may include each of the sets of CA certificates received at block **702**. The aggregate set of CA certificates may include a plurality of sets of CA certificates. The additional set of one or more network entities may access the aggregate set of CA certificates, and may utilize the plurality of sets of CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates, including, with respect to a particular set of CA certificates, to authenticate entity certificates issued to the particular set of one or more network entities by the particular CA corresponding to the particular set of CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates.

(183) In one example, distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the additional set of one or more network entities may include storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a certificate repository located in a different trust zone. The certificate repository may be accessible, directly or indirectly, by the additional set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the additional set of one or more network entities may include transmitting a notification to the additional set of one or more network entities. The notification may indicate that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in a certificate repository located, for example, in a different trust zone, for distribution to the additional set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the additional set of one or more network entities may include determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the certificate repository, located, for example, in a different trust zone. Responsive to determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the certificate repository, the additional set of one or more network entities may download the aggregate set of CA certificates from the certificate repository and may store the aggregate set of CA certificates in an additional certificate repository accessible, directly or indirectly, by the additional set of one or more network entities. In one example, the aggregate set of CA certificates may be downloaded and stored in an additional certificate repository that is located in a different trust zone relative to the certificate repository from which the aggregate set of CA certificates is downloaded.

(184) In one example, the operations at block **702** may include receiving, from a first CA service associated with a first CA, a first set of one or more CA certificates issued by the first CA. The first CA service may be located in a first trust zone. The first CA may be trusted by a first set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, operations at block **702** may include receiving, from a second CA service associated with a second CA, a second set of one or more CA certificates issued by the second CA. The second CA service may be located in a second trust zone. The second CA may be trusted by a second set of one or more network entities. The operations at block **706** may include aggregating in a certificate repository, the first set of one or more CA

certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates. The operations at block **708** may include distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates. The third set of one or more network entities may access the aggregate set of CA certificates and may utilize the first set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first CA to the first set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, the third set of one or more network entities may utilize the second set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second CA to the second set of one or more network entities.

(185) In one example, the third set of one or more network entities may use the first set of one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the first CA. Additionally, or in the alternative, the third set of one or more network entities may use the second set of one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the second CA. In one example, the first CA may be untrusted by the second set of one or more network entities, and/or the second CA may be untrusted by the first set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, the first CA may be untrusted by the third set of one or more network entities prior to the third set of one or more network entities using at least one first CA certificate of the first set of one or more CA certificates from the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate at least a first entity certificate of first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first CA. Additionally, or in the alternative, the second CA may be untrusted by the third set of one or more network entities prior to the third set of one or more network entities using at least one second CA certificate of the second set of one or more CA certificates from the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate at least a second entity certificate of second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second CA.

(186) In one example, the first set of one or more network entities may be located in the first trust zone, and the second set of one or more network entities are located in the second trust zone. Additionally, or in the alternative, the third set of one or more network entities may be located in the first trust zone, or the second trust zone. Additionally, or in the alternative, the third set of one or more network entities may be located in a third trust zone. In one example, the first trust zone may include a first ancillary region and/or a first ancillary VCN, the second trust zone may include a second ancillary region and/or a second ancillary VCN, and the third trust zone may include a home region and/or a home VCN. Alternatively, the first trust zone may include a home region or a home VCN, the second trust zone may include a first ancillary region and/or a first ancillary VCN, and the third trust zone may include a second ancillary region and/or a second ancillary VCN.

(187) In one example, the operations **700** may include aggregating CA certificates for use by an interzone CA service. The interzone CA service may use the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate network entities in connection with initially provisioning and/or updating interzone network entities that may communicate with other network entities located outside of a particular trust zone. The particular trust zone may include all or a portion of a virtual cloud network. Additionally, or in the alternative, the trust zone may include a plurality of virtual cloud networks. Additionally, or in the alternative, the particular trust zone may include a region that includes one or more virtual cloud networks. In one example, the third set of one or more network entities may include an intermediate service host. In one example, the intermediate service host may authenticate the first set of one or more entity certificates and the second set of one or more entity certificates. Subsequent to the intermediate service host authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates and the second set of one or more entity certificates, the first set of one or more network entities and the second set of one or more network entities may communicate and/or exchange data across at least one trust zone boundary via the intermediate service host.

(188) The operations at block **702** may include receiving, from a first intrazone CA service

associated with a first intrazone CA of a first trust zone, a first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates issued by the first intrazone CA. The first intrazone CA may be trusted by a first set of one or more network entities located in the first trust zone. Additionally, or in the alternative, operations at block **702** may include receiving, from a second intrazone CA service located in a second intrazone CA of a second trust zone, a second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates issued by the second intrazone CA. The second intrazone CA may be trusted by a second set of one or more network entities located in the second trust zone. The operations at block **706** may include aggregating in a certificate repository, the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates.

(189) The operations at block **708** may include distributing for access by one or more interzone network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates. The one or more interzone network entities may access the aggregate set of CA certificates and may utilize the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first intrazone CA to the first set of one or more network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, the one or more interzone network entities may utilize use the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second intrazone CA to the second set of one or more network entities.

(190) In one example, the operations **700** may include aggregating CA certificates for use by network entities that engage in interzone communications. The network entities may use the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate intrazone network entities and/or interzone network entities. The operations **700** with respect to aggregating CA certificates for use by network entities that engage in interzone communications may be performed in addition, or in the alternative to, the operations **700** aggregating CA certificates for use by an interzone CA service.

(191) The operations at block **702** may include receiving, from an intrazone CA service associated with an intrazone CA of a first trust zone, a first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates issued by the intrazone CA. The intrazone CA may be trusted by a first set of one or more intrazone network entities located in the first trust zone. Additionally, or in the alternative, operations at block **702** may include receiving, from an interzone CA service located in an interzone CA of a second trust zone, a second set of one or more interzone CA certificates issued by the interzone CA. The interzone CA may be trusted by a second set of one or more interzone network entities located in the second trust zone. The operations at block **706** may include aggregating in a certificate repository, the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates.

(192) The operations at block **708** may include distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates that includes the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates. The third set of one or more network entities may be located in the first trust zone. Alternatively, the third set of one or more network entities may be located in the second trust zone. Alternatively, the third set of one or more network entities may be located in a third trust zone. The third set of one or more network entities may access the aggregate set of CA certificates and utilize the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the intrazone CA to the first set of one or more intrazone network entities. Additionally, or in the alternative, the third set of one or more network entities may access the aggregate set of CA certificates and utilize the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the interzone CA to the second set of one or more interzone network entities.

6. Authenticating Network Entities

- (193) Network entities may utilize the CA certificates in a certificate bundle to authenticate other network entities associated with the virtual cloud network. For example, communications between network entities may be conducted according to a security protocol. The security protocol may include authenticating a network entity based on an entity certificate issued to the network entity by a CA, for example, prior to establishing communications with the network entity.
- (194) As used herein, the term “certificate bundle” refers to a file that contains one or more digital certificates. In one example, the one or more digital certificates in a certificate bundle may include CA certificates, such as root CA certificates or intermediate CA certificates.
- (195) In one example, the entity certificate and a CA certificate corresponding to the CA that issued the entity certificate may represent at least a portion of a certificate chain. To authenticate the network entity, each signature-key pair in the certificate chain is validated. In one example, a top-level CA may issue the entity certificate, in which case the certificate chain may include one signature-key pair—that is, the digital signature of the top-level CA in the entity certificate, and the public key of the top-level CA. Such a top-level CA is sometimes referred to as a root CA. In another example, the certificate chain may include signature-key pairs corresponding to multiple CA certificates. For example, a root CA may issue an intermediate CA certificate to an intermediate CA, and the intermediate CA may issue the entity certificate to the network entity. In this case, the certificate chain includes two signature-key pairs—that is, (i) the digital signature of the intermediate CA in the entity certificate, and the public key of the intermediate CA; and (ii) the digital signature of the root CA in the intermediate CA certificate, and the public key of the root CA.
- (196) As used herein, the term “certificate authority certificate” or “CA certificate” refers to a digital certificate issued by a CA to establish its own identity and authenticity. A CA certificate issued by a CA may include a public key corresponding to a private key held by the CA. A certificate authority certificate may be a root CA certificate or an intermediate CA certificate. A certificate authority certificate may be used to sign and issue other digital certificates, including those used for secure communication between network entities.
- (197) As used herein, the term “certificate authority” or “CA” refers to an entity responsible for issuing and managing digital certificates. The CA verifies the identity of network entities and digitally signs their certificates to attest to their authenticity.
- (198) As used herein, the term “root certificate authority certificate” or “root CA certificate” refers to a top-level CA certificate in a certificate chain or hierarchy. A root CA certificate may be self-issued and/or self-signed by a root CA. As used herein, the term “root CA” refers to a top-level CA in a CA hierarchy. A root CA may issue root CA certificates, intermediate CA certificates, or entity certificates.
- (199) As used herein, the term “intermediate certificate authority certificate” or “intermediate CA certificate” refers to an intermediate-level CA certificate in a certificate chain or hierarchy. An intermediate CA certificate may be issued by a root CA. An intermediate CA certificate is located between a root CA certificate and an entity certificate in a certificate chain or hierarchy. As used herein, the term “intermediate CA” refers to an intermediate-level CA in a CA hierarchy. An intermediate CA may issue entity certificates, for example, pursuant to authority granted to an intermediate CA according to a root CA.
- (200) As used herein, the term “entity certificate” refers to a digital certificate issued to an entity, such as a network entity associated with a virtual cloud network. An entity certificate may be used to verify the identity of the entity and enable secure communication between entities, such as between network entities in a virtual cloud network. An entity certificate may be issued by a CA, such as root CA or an intermediate CA.
- (201) In one example, an entity certificate may be an instance principal certificate. As used herein, the term “instance principal certificate” refers to a digital certificate used to authenticate and secure communication for an instance or VM associated with a virtual cloud network. In one example,

instances and VMs may be created, scaled, and terminated dynamically. Instance principal certificates may be associated with an instance or VM during its lifecycle and may be automatically generated and managed by the virtual cloud network infrastructure. An instance principal certificate may have limited access to communicate with certain network entities based on permissions assigned to the network entity to which the instance principal certificate is issued.

(202) As used herein, the term “digital certificate” refers to a digitally signed electronic document that binds a public key to the identity of an entity or certificate holder. The entity or certificate holder may hold a private key corresponding to the public key. The public key may be included in or associated with the digital certificate. The digital certificate may be validated by matching the public key to the private key through the use of cryptography. A digital certificate may conform to International Telecommunication Union standard X.509. A digital certificate may include an issuer's name, a certificate holder's name, a public key, issuer (CA) information, and expiration date. Digital certificates may be used in various security protocols, such as SSL/TLS, to establish the identity and authenticity of the communicating parties and facilitate secure communication.

7. Miscellaneous; Extensions

(203) Embodiments are directed to a system with one or more devices that include a hardware processor and that are configured to perform any of the operations described herein and/or recited in any of the claims below. Embodiments are directed to a system including means to perform any of the operations described herein and/or recited in any of the claims below. In an embodiment, a non-transitory computer readable storage medium comprises instructions which, when executed by one or more hardware processors, causes performance of any of the operations described herein and/or recited in any of the claims.

(204) Further aspects of the presently disclosed subject matter are provided by the following clauses:

(205) One or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing instructions, which when executed by one or more hardware processors, cause performance of operations comprising: receiving, from a first intrazone certificate authority (CA) service associated with a first intrazone CA of a first trust zone, a first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates issued by the first intrazone CA, wherein the first intrazone CA is trusted by a first set of one or more network entities associated with the first trust zone; receiving, from a second intrazone CA service associated with a second intrazone CA of a second trust zone, a second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates issued by the second intrazone CA, wherein the second intrazone CA is trusted by a second set of one or more network entities associated with the second trust zone; aggregating in a certificate repository, the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates; distributing for access by one or more interzone network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates comprising the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates, wherein the one or more interzone network entities (a) use the first set of one or more first intrazone CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first intrazone CA to the first set of one or more network entities and (b) use the second set of one or more second intrazone CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second intrazone CA to the second set of one or more network entities.

(206) One or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing instructions, which when executed by one or more hardware processors, cause performance of operations comprising: receiving, from an intrazone certificate authority (CA) service associated with an intrazone CA of a first trust zone, a first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates issued by the intrazone CA, wherein the intrazone CA is trusted by a first set of one or more intrazone network entities associated with the first trust zone; receiving, from an interzone CA service associated with an interzone CA of a second trust zone, a second set of one or more interzone CA certificates issued by the interzone CA, wherein the interzone CA is trusted by a second set of one or more interzone

network entities associated with the second trust zone; aggregating in a certificate repository, the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates; distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates comprising the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates and the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates, wherein the third set of one or more network entities (a) use the first set of one or more intrazone CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the intrazone CA to the first set of one or more intrazone network entities and (b) use the second set of one or more interzone CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the interzone CA to the second set of one or more interzone network entities.

(207) Any combination of the features and functionalities described herein may be used in accordance with one or more embodiments. In the foregoing specification, embodiments have been described with reference to numerous specific details that may vary from implementation to implementation. The specification and drawings are, accordingly, to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense. The sole and exclusive indicator of the scope of the invention, and what is intended by the applicants to be the scope of the invention, is the literal and equivalent scope of the set of claims that issue from this application, in the specific form in which such claims issue, including any subsequent correction.

(208) All references, including publications, patent applications, and patents, cited herein are hereby incorporated by reference to the same extent as if each reference were individually and specifically indicated to be incorporated by reference and were set forth in its entirety herein.

Claims

1. One or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing instructions, which when executed by one or more hardware processors, cause performance of operations comprising: receiving, from a first certificate authority (CA) service associated with a first CA, a first set of one or more CA certificates issued by the first CA, wherein the first CA service is located in a first trust zone, and wherein the first CA is trusted by a first set of one or more network entities; receiving, from a second CA service associated with a second CA, a second set of one or more CA certificates issued by the second CA, wherein the second CA service is located in a second trust zone, and wherein the second CA is trusted by a second set of one or more network entities; aggregating in a first certificate repository, the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates; distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates comprising the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates, wherein the third set of one or more network entities access the aggregate set of CA certificates, and (a) use the first set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first CA to the first set of one or more network entities and (b) use the second set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second CA to the second set of one or more network entities.
2. The media of claim 1, wherein the first set of one or more network entities are located in the first trust zone, and the second set of one or more network entities are located in the second trust zone.
3. The media of claim 1, wherein the third set of one or more network entities are located in at least one of: the first trust zone, or a third trust zone.
4. The media of claim 1, wherein the first trust zone comprises a home region, and wherein the second trust zone comprises an ancillary region.
5. The media of claim 1, wherein the first CA is untrusted by the second set of one or more network entities, and wherein the second CA is untrusted by the first set of one or more network entities.
6. The media of claim 1, wherein the third set of one or more network entities (a) use the first set of

one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the first CA, and (b) use the second set of one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the second CA.

7. The media of claim 1, wherein the third set of one or more network entities comprises an intermediate service host, and wherein, subsequent to the intermediate service host authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates and the second set of one or more entity certificates, the first set of one or more network entities and the second set of one or more network entities communicate and/or exchange data across at least one trust zone boundary via the intermediate service host.

8. The media of claim 1, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a second certificate repository accessible, directly or indirectly, by the third set of one or more network entities.

9. The media of claim 8, wherein the second certificate repository is located in a different trust zone relative to one or more of: the first set of one or more network entities and the second set of one or more network entities.

10. The media of claim 9, wherein the second certificate repository and the third set of one or more network entities are respectively located in a third trust zone.

11. The media of claim 8, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: transmitting a notification to the third set of one or more network entities, the notification indicating that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository for distribution to the third set of one or more network entities.

12. The media of claim 8, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository; and responsive to determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository: downloading the aggregate set of CA certificates from the second certificate repository; and storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible, directly or indirectly, by the third set of one or more network entities, wherein the third certificate repository is located in a different trust zone relative to the second certificate repository.

13. The media of claim 1, wherein the first trust zone comprises a first ancillary trust zone, wherein the first CA is a first intrazone CA of the first ancillary trust zone, and wherein the first set of one or more network entities are located in the first ancillary trust zone; and wherein the second trust zone comprises a second ancillary trust zone, wherein the second CA is a second intrazone CA of the second ancillary trust zone, and wherein the second set of one or more network entities are located in the second ancillary trust zone.

14. The media of claim 13, wherein the operations further comprise: initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: receiving, from the first set of one or more network entities, the first set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates via the first set of one or more CA certificates; receiving, from the second set of one or more network entities, the second set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the second set of one or more entity certificates via the second set of one or more CA certificates.

15. The media of claim 14, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible by the third set of one or more network entities.

16. The media of claim 1, wherein the first trust zone comprises an ancillary trust zone, wherein the first CA is an intrazone CA of the ancillary trust zone, and wherein the first set of one or more

network entities are located in the ancillary trust zone; and wherein the second trust zone is a home trust zone, wherein the second CA is a home CA of the home trust zone, wherein the second set of one or more network entities are located in the home trust zone.

17. The media of claim 16, wherein the operations further comprise: initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: receiving, from the first set of one or more network entities, the first set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates via the first set of one or more CA certificates; receiving, from the second set of one or more network entities, the second set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the second set of one or more entity certificates via the second set of one or more CA certificates.

18. The media of claim 17, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible by the third set of one or more network entities.

19. The media of claim 1, wherein a first network entity, of the first set of one or more network entities, is a first intrazone network entity; wherein a second network entity, of the second set of one or more network entities, is a second intrazone network entity; wherein a third network entity, of the third set of one or more network entities, is an interzone network entity located in a third trust zone; wherein the first intrazone network entity and the second intrazone network entity communicate and/or exchange data directly or indirectly with one another across a trust zone boundary in accordance with an interzone security protocol, wherein the interzone security protocol comprises the interzone network entity (a) authenticating the first intrazone network entity based at least in part on a first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates, and (b) authenticating the second intrazone network entity based at least in part on a second CA certificate, of the second set of one or more CA certificates.

20. The media of claim 1, wherein the first set of one or more network entities comprises an interzone network entity; wherein the second set of one or more network entities comprises a first intrazone network entity; wherein the third set of one or more network entities comprises a second intrazone network entity located in the second trust zone; wherein the second intrazone network entity and the interzone network entity communicate and/or exchange data with one another across a first trust zone boundary in accordance with an interzone security protocol, wherein the interzone security protocol comprises the second intrazone network entity authenticating the interzone network entity based at least in part on a first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates; wherein the first intrazone network entity and the second intrazone network entity communicate and/or exchange data with one another across a second trust zone boundary in accordance with an intrazone security protocol, wherein the intrazone security protocol comprises (a), the second intrazone network entity authenticating the interzone network entity based at least in part on the first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates and (b) the second intrazone network entity authenticating the first intrazone network entity based at least in part on a second CA certificate, of the second set of one or more CA certificates.

21. A method, comprising: receiving, from a first certificate authority (CA) service associated with a first CA, a first set of one or more CA certificates issued by the first CA, wherein the first CA service is located in a first trust zone, and wherein the first CA is trusted by a first set of one or more network entities; receiving, from a second CA service associated with a second CA, a second set of one or more CA certificates issued by the second CA, wherein the second CA service is located in a second trust zone, and wherein the second CA is trusted by a second set of one or more network entities; aggregating in a first certificate repository, the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates; distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates comprising the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates, wherein the third set of

one or more network entities access the aggregate set of CA certificates, and (a) use the first set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first CA to the first set of one or more network entities and (b) use the second set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second CA to the second set of one or more network entities; wherein the method is performed by at least one device including a hardware processor.

22. The method of claim 21, wherein the first set of one or more network entities are located in the first trust zone, and the second set of one or more network entities are located in the second trust zone.

23. The method of claim 21, wherein the third set of one or more network entities are located in at least one of: the first trust zone, or a third trust zone.

24. The method of claim 21, wherein the first trust zone comprises a home region, and wherein the second trust zone comprises an ancillary region.

25. The method of claim 21, wherein the first CA is untrusted by the second set of one or more network entities, and wherein the second CA is untrusted by the first set of one or more network entities.

26. The method of claim 21, wherein the third set of one or more network entities (a) use the first set of one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the first CA, and (b) use the second set of one or more CA certificates in the aggregate set of CA certificates to establish trust with the second CA.

27. The method of claim 21, wherein the third set of one or more network entities comprises an intermediate service host, and wherein, subsequent to the intermediate service host authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates and the second set of one or more entity certificates, the first set of one or more network entities and the second set of one or more network entities communicate and/or exchange data across at least one trust zone boundary via the intermediate service host.

28. The method of claim 21, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a second certificate repository accessible, directly or indirectly, by the third set of one or more network entities.

29. The method of claim 28, wherein the second certificate repository is located in a different trust zone relative to one or more of: the first set of one or more network entities and the second set of one or more network entities.

30. The method of claim 29, wherein the second certificate repository and the third set of one or more network entities are respectively located in a third trust zone.

31. The method of claim 28, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: transmitting a notification to the third set of one or more network entities, the notification indicating that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository for distribution to the third set of one or more network entities.

32. The method of claim 28, wherein distributing the aggregate set of CA certificates for access by the third set of one or more network entities comprises: determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository; and responsive to determining that the aggregate set of CA certificates is available in the second certificate repository: downloading the aggregate set of CA certificates from the second certificate repository; and storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible, directly or indirectly, by the third set of one or more network entities, wherein the third certificate repository is located in a different trust zone relative to the second certificate repository.

33. The method of claim 21, wherein the first trust zone comprises a first ancillary trust zone,

wherein the first CA is a first intrazone CA of the first ancillary trust zone, and wherein the first set of one or more network entities are located in the first ancillary trust zone; and wherein the second trust zone comprises a second ancillary trust zone, wherein the second CA is a second intrazone CA of the second ancillary trust zone, and wherein the second set of one or more network entities are located in the second ancillary trust zone.

34. The method of claim 21, wherein the method further comprises: initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: receiving, from the first set of one or more network entities, the first set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates via the first set of one or more CA certificates; receiving, from the second set of one or more network entities, the second set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the second set of one or more entity certificates via the second set of one or more CA certificates.

35. The method of claim 34, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible by the third set of one or more network entities.

36. The method of claim 21, wherein the first trust zone comprises an ancillary trust zone, wherein the first CA is an intrazone CA of the ancillary trust zone, and wherein the first set of one or more network entities are located in the ancillary trust zone; and wherein the second trust zone comprises a home trust zone, wherein the second CA is a home CA of the home trust zone, wherein the second set of one or more network entities are located in the home trust zone.

37. The method of claim 36, wherein the method further comprises: initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: receiving, from the first set of one or more network entities, the first set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the first set of one or more entity certificates via the first set of one or more CA certificates; receiving, from the second set of one or more network entities, the second set of one or more entity certificates, and authenticating the second set of one or more entity certificates via the second set of one or more CA certificates.

38. The method of claim 37, wherein initially provisioning or updating the third set of one or more network entities comprises: storing the aggregate set of CA certificates in a third certificate repository accessible by the third set of one or more network entities.

39. The method of claim 21, wherein a first network entity, of the first set of one or more network entities, is a first intrazone network entity; wherein a second network entity, of the second set of one or more network entities, is a second intrazone network entity; wherein a third network entity, of the third set of one or more network entities, is an interzone network entity located in a third trust zone; wherein the first intrazone network entity and the second intrazone network entity communicate and/or exchange data directly or indirectly with one another across a trust zone boundary in accordance with an interzone security protocol, wherein the interzone security protocol comprises the interzone network entity (a) authenticating the first intrazone network entity based at least in part on a first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates, and (b) authenticating the second intrazone network entity based at least in part on a second CA certificate, of the second set of one or more CA certificates.

40. The method of claim 21, wherein the first set of one or more network entities comprises an interzone network entity; wherein the second set of one or more network entities comprises a first intrazone network entity; wherein the third set of one or more network entities comprises a second intrazone network entity located in the second trust zone; wherein the second intrazone network entity and the interzone network entity communicate and/or exchange data with one another across a first trust zone boundary in accordance with an interzone security protocol, wherein the interzone security protocol comprises the second intrazone network entity authenticating the interzone

network entity based at least in part on a first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates; wherein the first intrazone network entity and the second intrazone network entity communicate and/or exchange data with one another across a second trust zone boundary in accordance with an intrazone security protocol, wherein the intrazone security protocol comprises (a), the second intrazone network entity authenticating the interzone network entity based at least in part on the first CA certificate, of the first set of one or more CA certificates and (b) the second intrazone network entity authenticating the first intrazone network entity based at least in part on a second CA certificate, of the second set of one or more CA certificates.

41. A system comprising: at least one hardware processor; the system being configured to execute operations, using the at least one hardware processor, the operations comprising: receiving, from a first certificate authority (CA) service associated with a first CA, a first set of one or more CA certificates issued by the first CA, wherein the first CA service is located in a first trust zone, and wherein the first CA is trusted by a first set of one or more network entities; receiving, from a second CA service associated with a second CA, a second set of one or more CA certificates issued by the second CA, wherein the second CA service is located in a second trust zone, and wherein the second CA is trusted by a second set of one or more network entities; aggregating in a first certificate repository, the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates; distributing for access by a third set of one or more network entities, an aggregate set of CA certificates comprising the first set of one or more CA certificates and the second set of one or more CA certificates, wherein the third set of one or more network entities access the aggregate set of CA certificates, and (a) use the first set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a first set of one or more entity certificates issued by the first CA to the first set of one or more network entities and (b) use the second set of one or more CA certificates of the aggregate set of CA certificates to authenticate a second set of one or more entity certificates issued by the second CA to the second set of one or more network entities.
